

AEGIS

ASTRAL EXPANSE GALACTIC INTERLINK SYSTEM

D10 CORE RULEBOOK

Compilation Edition

*Superhuman operations, interstellar conflict, occult power,
and civilization-scale consequences.*

System manuscript - July 2026

About This Edition

This compilation brings the currently established AEGIS D10 rules into one organized manuscript. It consolidates character creation, species, Powers, conflict systems, equipment, campaign operations, large-scale warfare, projects, bases, testing standards, and legacy conversion. It is intended as a playable core rules reference and a production manuscript for further editorial layout.

VALIDATION STATUS

The mechanical frameworks and catalogues are compiled here. Formal mathematical simulation and recorded campaign playtesting remain empirical tasks. The book identifies intended acceptance targets but does not claim that those targets have already been validated through completed table sessions.

AEGIS is the Astral Expanse Galactic Interlink System, an intergalactic authority supported by Alder power and enforced through institutions including PARAGON and the modern JSS. The original JSS was the independent Justice Society of Sovereigns. The modern JSS is the AEGIS-sponsored successor that leads PARAGON. "JSA" is not a valid term in this setting.

Kurathi are not a standard player species. Mythos is the sole playable exception unless future canon explicitly changes that restriction.

How to Use This Book

- Players should begin with Character Creation, then consult Skills, Species, Powers, Merits, Backgrounds, and Equipment.
- The GM should use Encounter Difficulty, Mission Structure, Hazards, Security templates, and Mass Combat as preparation tools.
- Specific Powers, Techniques, equipment, and species traits override general rules only within their stated scope.
- The current canonical precedence is: latest explicit canon, consolidated core rule, subsystem rule, catalogue entry, character or item exception, then worked example.

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1. Core System | Dice, actions, time, and universal procedures

AEGIS uses ten-sided dice. Ordinary actions use an Attribute + Skill pool. Direct Power actions use the governing Attribute + Power Rating. When a Power enhances a skilled action, roll Attribute + Skill and apply only the Technique's listed enhancement; do not routinely add the full Power Rating to an Attribute + Skill pool.

Core Resolution

Situation	Pool
Ordinary action	Attribute + Skill
Direct Power action	Governing Attribute + Power Rating
Skilled action enhanced by Power	Attribute + Skill; Technique adds listed dice, automatic successes, Scale, or effect
Opposed action	Both sides roll; defender wins ties
Extended action	Accumulate final successes toward a threshold

Successes, 1s, 10s, and Botches

- Natural 10s explode recursively. Roll another die for each natural 10; new 10s also explode.
- A natural 1 cancels one success.
- A botch occurs when more than half of the original rolled dice show natural 1s. Explosion dice never count toward botch determination.
- A 1 rolled on an explosion die cancels a success but cannot create a botch.
- When a permitted action has a zero or negative pool, roll one desperation die. It botches on 1 and explodes on 10.

Traits Above 10

For each trait used in a roll, roll no more than 10 dice from that trait. Each full point above 10 becomes one automatic success. Build each trait separately before combining the pool.

EXAMPLE

A character with Dexterity 13 and Firearms 8 contributes 10 rolled Dexterity dice, 3 automatic successes, and 8 rolled Skill dice before modifiers. Pool construction, ordinary caps, and automatic successes are then resolved using the normal modifier order.

Modifier Order

1. Build the base pool.
2. Convert trait points above 10 into automatic successes.
3. Apply ordinary bonuses and penalties, then cancel them against one another.
4. Apply the ordinary modifier cap of +5 or -5.
5. Add Teamwork dice separately, maximum +5.
6. Apply exceptional modifiers, including Scale penalties.
7. Roll, add automatic successes, resolve exploding 10s and natural 1 cancellation.

Difficulty and Opposed Rolls

Difficulty	Benchmark
1	Routine task under pressure
2	Standard trained challenge
3	Challenging professional action
5	Exceptional specialist achievement
7	Legendary achievement
10+	Planetary, civilization-scale, or seemingly impossible action

In an opposed roll, net successes equal the attacker's final successes minus the defender's final successes. One or more net successes wins. The defender wins ties. Five or more net successes is a Critical Success. Each additional full five net successes may add another critical benefit at GM discretion.

Teamwork

Choose one leader. Helpers roll appropriate pools. A helper who achieves at least 2 final successes grants the leader +1 Teamwork die. Each helper grants no more than one die. Teamwork dice are capped at +5 and are separate from the ordinary modifier cap. Different relevant Skills may assist the same action.

Extended Actions

Complexity	Threshold	Maximum Intervals
Minor	5	3
Standard	10	5
Complex	15	6
Major	25	8
Legendary	40	10
Planetary	60+	GM or project limit

- A successful interval adds final successes to Progress.
- Failure adds no Progress.
- A botch removes 3 Progress, minimum 0, and creates a complication.
- An interruption normally requires Resolve + relevant Skill or Intelligence + Skill, difficulty 2. Failure loses 2 Progress; a destructive interruption may lose 5 or force a restart.

Willpower

Maximum Willpower equals Resolve + Composure. Characters normally begin a session or mission with full Willpower. A character may normally spend one Willpower on their own turn and one additional Willpower on a Reaction or defense before their next turn. Only one Willpower may modify a single roll.

- Add +3 dice before a roll.
- Reroll up to three failed dice after a roll; replacement results stand.
- Resist compulsion, emotion, a defining Flaw, or a prohibited command.
- Remain conscious or active for one turn when otherwise unable.
- Reroll a failed Strain-control test or prevent a Power loss for one turn.
- Ignore wound penalties until the next turn.

A Short Rest restores 1 Willpower once between Full Rests. A Full Rest restores all Willpower. The GM may restore 1 Willpower for a major goal, sacrifice, serious defining-Flaw consequence, or major motivation, normally once per scene.

Time and Action Economy

A personal-combat round is approximately six seconds. Each character normally receives one Standard Action, one Movement Action, one Minor Action, one Reaction, and reasonable Free Actions. The Reaction refreshes at the start of the character's turn.

Action	Typical Uses
Standard	Attack, major Skill action, Technique, maneuver, Sprint, extended-action interval
Movement	Move by Speed, split movement around a Standard Action when permitted
Minor	Draw item, brief setup, simple interaction, some Techniques
Reaction	Active defense, counterattack, protect another, Reaction Technique
Full	Consumes Standard + Movement; used for major attacks, rituals, or complex actions
Free	Brief communication, release object, minor narrative interaction

- Unused actions expire, except a Reaction remains available until it refreshes.
- Delay moves the entire turn to a later initiative point and permanently changes initiative.
- Ready consumes a Standard Action and reserves the Reaction for a specified trigger.
- Interrupts resolve in descending Initiative, then Wits, then Dexterity; unresolved ties are simultaneous.
- Extra actions are rare. A character may gain only one extra action of a given type per turn and cannot create self-sustaining action loops. Extra Standard Actions are normally Signature or Ultimate effects.
- Repeated attacks on the character's own turn suffer -3, -6, and -9 exceptional penalties for the second, third, and fourth attacks. Reaction attacks are tracked separately.

Movement and Zones

Speed equals 5 + Dexterity + Size, minimum 1. Movement steps convert Speed into Zones.

Speed	Zones
1-9	1
10-19	2
20-29	3
30-39	4
40-49	5
Each additional full 10	+1

A Standard Action spent to Sprint doubles normal Movement. Combat range bands are Engaged 0-10 feet, Near 10-100 feet, Far 100-500 feet, Extreme 500 feet-2 miles, and Strategic beyond Extreme.

Size

Size	Approximate Height or Length
-3	Under 1 foot
-2	1-3 feet
-1	3-5 feet
0	5-8 feet
+1	8-15 feet
+2	15-30 feet
+3	30-100 feet
+4	100-300 feet
+5	300-1,000 feet

Evasion Size modifiers run from +3 for Size -3 to -3 for Size +3 or larger. Block uses the opposite modifier, capped at +/-3.

Universal Scale

Scale	Designation
S0	Personal
S1	Tactical
S2	Structural
S3	City
S4	Regional
S5	Planetary
S6	Stellar
S7	Galactic
S8	Cosmic

Potency, Area, Movement, and Structure Scale are tracked separately. Tier, Power Rating, range, and Magnitude do not automatically grant Scale.

Scale Difference	Effect
One step higher	+3 exceptional dice for the higher side
Two steps higher	+6 exceptional dice and +1 automatic success
Three or more	Lower side cannot directly contest without Scale-Breaker, weak point, Combined Power, objective action, or another explicit permission

- An attack one Scale above a Protection source halves that Protection.
- An attack two or more Scales above normally ignores ordinary Protection unless the defense is hardened.
- An attack one Scale below a Structure target deals half final damage to global Structure, or attacks a component.
- An attack two or more Scales below cannot damage global Structure without a weak point, component, Scale-Breaker, or similar permission.
- Scale-Breaker X counts the effect as X Scales higher only for the named interaction.

2. Unified Character Creation | A fixed, audited creation sequence

All characters use the same creation sequence. Tier determines starting resources and caps, not personality, narrative importance, or moral authority.

8. Choose concept, allegiance, and campaign Tier.
9. Choose species and Lineage or Heritage.
10. Assign Attribute categories.
11. Apply species adjustments and favored caps.
12. Purchase Skills and legal Specializations.
13. Purchase Powers, Branches, Techniques, Refinements, and Signature upgrades.
14. Purchase Merits and optional Flaws.
15. Purchase Backgrounds.
16. Select equipment.
17. Record Reputation and Threat Classification.
18. Calculate derived traits.
19. Complete the final legality audit.

Tier Creation Table

Tier	Attributes P/S/T	Attr Cap	Skills	Skill Cap	Specs	PP	Max Power	Merits	Backgrounds/Max	EP	Reserve Base
Civilian	6/4/2	4	20	4	2	0-3	3	4	3/2	3	+3 or 0
Enhanced	9/6/3	5	28	5	3	8	4	6	5/3	5	+6
Street	12/8/4	6	36	6	4	15	6	8	6/3	7	+10
Standard	15/10/5	8	44	7	6	24	8	10	8/4	9	+15
PARAGON	18/12/6	10	52	8	8	36	10	12	10/5	12	+21
JSS	22/15/8	12	60	9	10	52	12	14	12/6	15	+28
Planetary	27/18/9	13	68	10	12	70	13	16	14/7	18	+36
Interstellar	31/21/11	14	76	10	14	90	14	18	16/8	22	+45
Cosmic	36/24/12	15	84	10	16	120	15	22	20/9	28	+55

ATTRIBUTE ALLOCATION

Every Attribute begins at 1. The Primary, Secondary, and Tertiary values are bonus dots added to those starting ratings. Species bonuses are applied after the category allocations. A favored racial Attribute may exceed the Tier cap by 1.

Concept Record

- Civilian name and heroic, vigilante, or operational identity
- Species, allegiance, origin, and role
- Motivation and defining relationship
- Signature capability and principal limitation
- Combat contribution and noncombat contribution
- The resource, duty, relationship, or Flaw that creates pressure

Attributes

Category	Attributes
Physical	Strength, Dexterity, Stamina
Mental	Intelligence, Wits, Resolve
Social	Charisma, Manipulation, Composure

Spend every category allocation. Apply species bonuses afterward. No Attribute may exceed the Tier cap, except a favored racial Attribute may reach cap +1.

Skills and Specializations

Skills begin at 0. Spend the entire Skill allocation. A Specialization slot unlocks in a Skill at ratings 4, 6, 8, and 10. A relevant Specialization grants +1 die. Normally only one applies to a roll. Unused Tier picks may be banked until a Skill unlocks a new slot.

Powers

Purchase the parent Power first, then rating increases, Branches, Techniques, Refinements, and Signature upgrades. A racial free Power begins at rating 1 and waives only its initial Scope cost.

Scope	Initial PP at Rating 1
Focused	1
Standard	2
Framework	3
Authority	5

New Rating	PP Cost
2-10	1 each
11-12	2 each
13-14	3 each
15	4

Minimum Rating	Technique Tier	PP
1	Minor	1
3	Standard	1
5	Strong	2
7	Major	2
9	Grand	3
12	Ultimate	4
15	Cosmic	6

Merits and Optional Flaws

Spend the Tier Merit allocation. Optional personal Flaws grant one additional Merit Point per Flaw Point, to a maximum of three bonus Merit Points. Mandatory racial Flaws grant no points. Flaws must create meaningful consequences rather than cosmetic inconvenience.

Backgrounds and Equipment

Backgrounds are external advantages such as Resources, Status, or a Safe Haven. No starting Background may exceed the Tier maximum. Equipment must fit the character's Equipment Points, Grade access, Backgrounds, organization, and narrative origin. Grade-6 equipment normally also requires character investment or story permission.

Derived Traits

Trait	Formula
Health	10 + Stamina x2 + Size x2; minimum 3
Willpower	Resolve + Composure
Power Reserve	Resolve + Tier Reserve Base
Strain Limit	Stamina + Resolve
Initiative	Wits + Dexterity
Speed	5 + Dexterity + Size; minimum 1
Evasion	Dexterity + Athletics + Size modifier
Parry	Dexterity + Melee + weapon or Technique
Block	Stamina + Athletics + Size modifier + shield or Technique
Mental Defense	Resolve + Composure
Social Defense	Composure + Wits
Passive Awareness	(Wits + Awareness) / 3, rounded up; minimum 1, plus automatic successes

Final Legality Audit

- Tier, point pools, and caps are correct.
- Every Attribute began at 1; category allocations and species bonuses are correctly ordered.
- Skill totals and Specialization slot limits are legal.
- Every Power Scope, Branch, Technique prerequisite, and rating cost is paid.
- Merit points and optional Flaw bonuses are correct; mandatory racial Flaws are present.
- Background points and starting maximums are legal.
- Equipment Points, Grade, access, and signature-item protections are recorded.
- Reserve, Strain Limit, Health, defenses, Size, and every Scale permission are calculated.
- Reputation, Threat Classification, and racial continuity requirements are recorded.

3. Skills | Twenty-nine fields of training and expertise

A character with Skill 0 may attempt most ordinary uses with the relevant Attribute alone. Professional tasks attempted untrained suffer -2 ordinary dice and cannot achieve advanced outcomes. Surgery, advanced hacking, engineering design, explosive construction, Aetheric ritual work, alien biological treatment, advanced piloting, and strategic command normally require Skill 1 or more.

Physical and Combat Skills

Skill	Scope	Common Attributes	Specializations
Athletics	Running, climbing, jumping, swimming, balance, lifting technique, restraint escape.	Strength, Dexterity, Stamina	Climbing, Swimming, Sprinting, Acrobatics, Endurance
Brawl	Unarmed combat, natural weapons, grappling, pins, chokes, close control.	Strength, Dexterity, Stamina	Grappling, Striking, Natural Weapons, Countering
Melee	Manufactured close-combat weapons, shields, parrying, weapon maneuvers.	Strength, Dexterity	Blades, Blunt Weapons, Polearms, Shields, Exotic Weapons
Firearms	Personal projectile and directed-energy weapons.	Dexterity, Wits	Pistols, Rifles, Shotguns, Sniper Weapons, Energy Arms
Heavy Weapons	Crew-served weapons, launchers, artillery, powered heavy arms, emplacements.	Strength, Dexterity, Intelligence	Launchers, Artillery, Vehicle Weapons, Siege Arms
Stealth	Hiding, silent movement, shadowing, sensor avoidance through movement discipline.	Dexterity, Wits, Composure	Urban, Wilderness, Shadowing, Infiltration, Camouflage
Larceny	Locks, traps, sleight of hand, physical intrusion, concealment, bypass tools.	Dexterity, Intelligence, Wits	Lockpicking, Traps, Pickpocketing, Security Bypass
Piloting	Vehicles, vessels, powered flight platforms, and complex transport.	Dexterity, Wits, Intelligence	Ground, Air, Space, Aquatic, Aetheric Craft
Survival	Navigation, tracking, foraging, shelter, wilderness and environmental endurance.	Wits, Stamina, Intelligence	Tracking, Desert, Arctic, Aquatic, Urban Ruins

Mental and Technical Skills

Skill	Scope	Common Attributes	Specializations
Awareness	Immediate perception, ambush detection, sensor interpretation, noticing threats.	Wits, Intelligence	Visual, Auditory, Sensors, Ambushes, Energy Signatures
Investigation	Evidence collection, reconstruction, interviews, patterns, case development.	Intelligence, Wits	Forensics, Crime Scenes, Missing Persons, Financial, Conspiracies
Medicine	Diagnosis, treatment, surgery, pharmaceuticals, biological rehabilitation.	Intelligence, Wits, Dexterity	Trauma, Surgery, Psychiatry, Alien Medicine, Pharmacology
Technology	Operate, program, diagnose, and hack existing technology.	Intelligence, Wits	Hacking, Networks, Sensors, Software, Aether-Tech Interfaces
Engineering	Design, build, modify, and physically repair mechanical and structural systems.	Intelligence, Dexterity	Mechanical, Structural, Power Systems, Cybernetics, Armor
Demolitions	Explosive construction, placement, disposal, blast shaping, breaching.	Intelligence, Dexterity, Wits	Breaching, Disposal, Traps, Artillery Charges
Science	Empirical theory, experimentation, mathematics, chemistry, physics, and biology.	Intelligence, Wits	Physics, Biology, Chemistry, Astronomy, Dimensional Science
Academics	History, law, politics, culture, languages, philosophy, scholarship.	Intelligence, Wits	History, Law, Languages, Politics, Archaeology
Occult	Myth, supernatural entities, curses, rituals, symbolic systems, occult lore.	Intelligence, Wits, Resolve	Spirits, Curses, Ritual Lore, Prophecy, Cosmic Entities
Aethercraft	Diagnose, construct, control, and counter Aetheric effects and rituals.	Intelligence, Resolve, Wits	Wards, Mysteries, Enchantment, Rituals, Counterweaving
Xenology	Alien species, cultures, physiology, artifacts, ecosystems, communication.	Intelligence, Wits, Empathy	Species, Alien Medicine, Alien Technology, First Contact
Strategy	Operational planning, battlefield command, logistics, deployment, threat analysis.	Intelligence, Wits, Resolve	Tactics, Logistics, Naval, Planetary Defense, Counterinsurgency

Social Skills

Skill	Scope	Common Attributes	Specializations
Persuasion	Honest argument, negotiation, diplomacy, requests, bargaining.	Charisma, Manipulation, Intelligence	Negotiation, Diplomacy, Appeals, Mediation
Deception	Lies, cover stories, impersonation, false intent, behavioral disguise.	Manipulation, Composure, Charisma	Disguise, Impersonation, Misdirection, False Credentials
Intimidation	Threats, coercive presence, interrogation pressure, demonstrations of force.	Charisma, Manipulation, Strength	Interrogation, Physical Threats, Command Presence
Leadership	Command, morale, coordination, inspiration, crisis management.	Charisma, Resolve, Composure	Military, Emergency Response, Political, Team Coordination
Empathy	Emotional states, motives, distress, relationships, sincerity.	Wits, Composure, Intelligence	Counseling, Trauma, Motives, Group Dynamics
Etiquette	Formal conduct, protocol, diplomacy, ceremony, institutional behavior.	Intelligence, Charisma, Composure	Alder Houses, AEGIS, Warg Houses, Corporate, Diplomatic
Performance	Music, acting, public speaking, dance, spectacle, audience control.	Charisma, Dexterity, Composure	Acting, Oratory, Music, Dance, Broadcast
Streetwise	Criminal culture, informal networks, rumors, urban navigation, black markets.	Wits, Manipulation, Charisma	Gangs, Black Markets, Rumors, Urban Survival

Skill Boundaries

- Technology operates, programs, diagnoses, and hacks existing systems. Engineering designs, fabricates, modifies, and physically repairs them.
- Awareness notices immediate information. Investigation reconstructs what happened and establishes a case.
- Occult understands supernatural traditions. Aethercraft performs or counters Aetheric work when the character has permission.
- Persuasion presents an honest argument. Deception creates false belief. Intimidation creates pressure through fear or force.
- Survival manages environments and tracking. Medicine treats biological harm. Xenology supplies alien-specific knowledge.
- A Skill never grants ownership, rank, legal permission, Power access, or equipment by itself.

4. Merits, Flaws, Backgrounds, and Reputation | Internal advantages, external access, and public identity

Merits and Flaws

Merits are persistent internal advantages. Flaws are persistent disadvantages. Racial Flaws are mandatory and grant no points. Optional personal Flaws grant one Merit Point per Flaw Point, maximum three bonus points at creation. Removing an optional Flaw costs 5 XP per point and requires a narrative method.

Merit Rating	Benchmark
1	Narrow but reliable
2	Strong professional advantage
3	Major defining advantage
4	Exceptional or transformative
5	Rare, campaign-defining, or setting-sensitive

Merit Catalogue

Category	Merits
Physical	Ambidextrous 1; Acute Sense 1 per sense, max 3; Powerful Build 2; Iron Lungs 1; Rapid Recovery 2; Toughened Physique 2/4; Environmental Adaptation 2; Sure-Footed 1
Mental	Eidetic Recall 2; Iron Will 2; Focused Mind 2; Danger Sense 3; Intuitive Analyst 1; Polyglot 1-3; Lucid Mind 2; Composed Under Pressure 1
Social	Commanding Presence 2; Empathic Rapport 2; Trusted Face 1; Silver Tongue 2; Unshakable Poise 1; Cultural Fluency 1 per culture, max 3; Inspiring Presence 3; Networker 2
Combat	Combat Reflexes 2; Defensive Specialist 2; Maneuver Training 1 per maneuver, max 3; Quick Draw 1; Guardian 2; Close-Quarters Expert 2; Deadeye 2; Battlefield Mobility 2; Counterfighter 3; Resilient Combatant 2
Power	Deep Reserve 1-5 (+2 Reserve/point); Efficient Channeling 2; Stable Conduit 2; Strain Tolerance 2/rank, max 2; Rapid Centering 2; Suppression Resistance 2/4; Sustained Focus 2; Safe Overcharge 3; Scale Specialist 3; Suppression-Shielded Power 2
Racial Optional	Hybrid Heritage 3; Expanded Racial Gift 2; Reinforced Continuity Anchor 3; Ancestral Memory 2; Lineage Mastery 2; Adaptive Metabolism 2; Species Paragon 4
Organizational	Field Authority 2; Requisition Priority 2; Institutional Shield 2; Secure Identity 1; Rapid Response Protocol 2; Command Staff 3; Interagency Access 2; Mission Review Protection 3

Flaw Catalogue

Category	Flaws
General	Distinctive 1; Bad Reputation 1-3; Secret 1-3; Dependent 1-3; Debt 1-3; Restricted Access 1-3
Physical	Frail 2/4; Slow 1-2; Impaired Sense 1-3; Fragile Frame 2; Chronic Injury 1-3; Environmental Intolerance 1-3; Medical Dependency 2; Vulnerable Anatomy 2
Psychological/Behavioral	Code 1-3; Compulsion 1-3; Phobia 1-3; Short Temper 2; Obsession 1-3; Reckless 2; Pacifist 2-3; Gullible 1
Power Weaknesses	Activation Requirement 1-3; Obvious Tell 1; Limited Source 2-4; Backlash 2-4; Cooldown 1-3; Concentration Bound 2; Countermeasure Vulnerability 2-4; Suppression Susceptibility 2; Unstable Power 2; Reduced Scale 1-3; Reserve Hunger 2; Power Lockout 3
Obligations/Enemies	Duty 1-3; Oath 1-3; Patron's Claim 1-3; Rival 1-2; Enemy 1-5; Hunted 2-5; Bounty 1-4; Legal Restriction 1-3; Faction Feud 1-3; Protected Dependent 1-3

Background States

State	Effect
Ready	Functions normally.

State	Effect
Strained	Routine use remains; major use suffers -2 dice or creates an Obligation. Recovery normally requires 1 DA and a relevant difficulty-2 action.
Unavailable	Principal benefit cannot currently be used. Recovery requires a Standard or Complex project, replacement, repayment, or narrative restoration.

A purchased Background cannot be permanently removed without a recovery route, equivalent replacement, or character-point protection.

Background Rating Bands

Rating	Reach
1	Minor personal or local
2	Reliable local
3	Significant professional or regional
4	Elite regional
5	Major planetary
6	High interstellar
7	Civilization-level
8	Galactic
9	Intergalactic
10	Unprecedented setting-level

Background Catalogue

Background	Core Use
Resources	Disposable wealth, credit, property income, and financial resilience. Routine purchases within rating are automatic; exceptional purchases use difficulty 2 + Grade - rating, minimum 1. Resources does not replace Equipment Access.
Allies	Individuals or groups willing to provide meaningful aid. Allies have motives and limits and are not Retainers. Dangerous requests may create Obligations.
Contacts	Information, introductions, specialists, rumors, and informal access. Contacts normally provide information rather than direct action.
Influence	Ability to shape institutional decisions, approvals, policies, and resource direction. Influence is not formal command.
Status	Recognized rank, title, office, or standing within a jurisdiction. It grants authority only where the title is recognized.
Clearance	Authorization for restricted information, facilities, systems, or operations. Clearance grants permission, not competence.
Safe Haven	Permanent controlled location using the Safe Haven and Lair system. It does not automatically provide staff, equipment, or authority.
Equipment Access	Legal, organizational, or logistical access to equipment. Grade shortfall uses difficulty 2 + shortfall, maximum 7. Access may be temporary rather than ownership.
Vehicle	Access to a completed vehicle or vessel profile. The Background does not construct vehicles.
Patron	Powerful sponsor providing resources, protection, training, missions, or access, with corresponding claims and obligations.
Retainers	Loyal assistants, agents, technicians, guards, or support personnel with completed profiles. They do not grant unrestricted extra player turns.

Status Benchmarks

Rating	Example
1	Recognized member or junior official
2	Experienced professional or local officer
3	Senior local or regional authority
4	Elite command or planetary official

Rating	Example
5	High PARAGON authority
6	JSS standing
7	Great Warg House leader or equivalent
8	Alder House leader or civilization ruler
9	AEGIS Council level
10	Unprecedented formal authority

Reputation

Reputation is separate from Status and Influence. Each Reputation records Descriptor, Audience, Rating, Facet, Visibility, Scope, identity, evidence, Reputation Points, and optional Threat Class.

Rating	Recognition
1	Emerging
2	Established
3	Prominent
4	Famous
5	Legendary

Rating	Impact
1-2	1
3-4	2
5	3

- Facets include Admired, Respected, Trusted, Feared, Distrusted, Hated, Notorious, and Mixed.
- Visibility may be Public, Restricted, Secret, or False/Misattributed.
- Recognition difficulty is 6 - Rating, minimum 1; adjacent audiences add +1, outside Scope +3 or impossible. Restricted recognition adds +2; Secret recognition adds +4 and requires access.
- A favorable Facet adds Impact dice to relevant social actions. A negative Facet raises defenses or Attitude. Normally one favorable and one unfavorable Reputation apply per conflict.
- Reputation may provide Leverage 1 once per conflict; Rating 5 may provide Leverage 2.
- Reputation Point thresholds are 3, 8, 15, 24, and 35 for Ratings 1-5.

Threat Classification

Class	Designation
0	Unrated
1	Local
2	Enhanced
3	Superhuman
4	PARAGON
5	JSS
6	Planetary
7	Interstellar
8	Cosmic or Existential

Threat Classification affects planning and response. It is not a direct statistic and is not identical to character Tier.

5. Playable Species and Warg Lineages | Biology and metaphysics, separate from culture and rank

SPECIES PACKAGE STANDARD

A normal species package provides +3 Attribute total, no more than +2 to one Attribute; +1 Skill; one Specialization; two favored caps; one free racial Power at rating 1; access to at least one additional racial Power; exactly three racial Merits; and exactly three mandatory racial Flaws. Political authority, wealth, equipment, and House standing require Backgrounds.

Humans

- +1 to any three Attributes, or +2 to one and +1 to another.
- Any two favored Attribute caps.
- +1 to any Skill and one relevant Specialization.
- Free Power: Human Potential 1. Access: Adrenal Surge.
- Human Potential basic effect: once per scene after failing an Attribute + Skill roll, spend 1 Energy to gain +2 dice on the next attempt before the scene ends.
- Merits: Adaptive Learning, Cooperative Problem Solving, Cultural Breadth.
- Flaws: Mortal Continuity, Baseline Physiology, Sustenance Dependence.

Wargs

Warg Lineage is biological. House is cultural and political. A Warg selects one Lineage Module; specific modules replace, rather than stack with, a broad generic Lineage.

- +1 Wits, +1 Stamina, and +1 Lineage Attribute.
- Favored caps: Wits and the Lineage Attribute.
- +1 Survival and a Tracking or Lineage Specialization.
- Free Power: Heightened Senses 1.
- Access: choose two among Super Strength, Super Endurance, Super Speed, or permitted Flight, plus Lineage access.
- Merits: Natural Weapon (+1 BD Lethal), Pack Coordination, Lineage Adaptation.
- Flaws: Instinctive Trigger, Distinctive Physiology, Lineage Limitation.

Warg Lineage Modules

Lineage	Attribute	Merit	Flaw	Adaptation	Power Access
Lupine	Dexterity	Pursuit: +2 tracking and chase endurance	Isolation Stress	Cold and pursuit adaptation	Strength, Endurance, Speed
Reptilian	Strength	Scaled Hide: Natural Protection 1	Cold-Blooded	Heat/arid adaptation	Strength, Endurance, Biomass
Avian	Dexterity	Aerial Frame: +2 aerial movement; Flight access	Hollow Frame	Altitude and turbulence	Flight, Speed
Aquarian	Resolve	Amphibious	Dehydration	Aquatic adaptation	Endurance, Communion
Sapian	Intelligence	Prehensile Mobility: +2	Fine Frame: -1 Stability	Climbing and dense terrain	Intelligence-linked Powers
Ursine	Strength	Powerful Frame	Heavy Gait	Cold and wilderness	Strength, Endurance
Regalius	Charisma	Adaptive Hybrid: +2 one chosen niche	Genetic Instability	Designed niche	Morphology, selected Power
Fox	Dexterity	Ghoststep: +2 Stealth in cover, darkness, snow, crowds, or clutter	Light Frame	Cold and snow	Invisibility; Mimicry/Morphology
Coyote	Wits	Opportunistic Survivor: +2 improvised supplies, routes, scavenging, or revealed weakness	High Metabolism	Wasteland and urban ruins	Mimicry; Environmental Adaptation; Invisibility
Jackal	Resolve	Death-Scent: +2 to detect blood, remains, dying, decomposition, or biocontamination	Cold Intolerance	Desert physiology	Telepathy Perception/Memory; Soul/Seer
Falcon	Dexterity	Dive Hunter: +2 first descending aerial attack and +2 Knockback Margin	Hollow Frame	High altitude	Flight; Speed; vision; kinetic/atmospheric projection
Owl	Wits	Silent Wings: +2 Stealth while flying or gliding	Bright-Light Sensitivity	Nocturnal vision	Flight; Telepathy Perception; Invisibility
Corax	Charisma	Perfect Mimicry: +2 Performance/Deception reproducing heard voices or sounds	Hollow Frame	Aerial scavenger	Flight; sonic projection; Communion; Mimicry
Cobra	Dexterity	Venomous Bite: Poisoned 1 or 2 after Lethal bite	Cold-Blooded	Arid hunter	Biomass mutation/assimilation; Invisibility; Morphology

Lineage	Attribute	Merit	Flaw	Adaptation	Power Access
Frog	Dexterity	Leaping Frame: +2 jumps and Zone-crossing leap with landing	Permeable Skin	Amphibious respiration	Biomass adaptation; toxin/acid/sonic projection; burst speed
Tortoise	Stamina	Protective Shell: Natural Protection 2; braced +2 Stability	Slow Gait	Survival metabolism	Endurance; Regeneration; Force Fields; Adaptation
Gecko	Dexterity	Adhesive Pads: walk walls/ceilings and +2 forced-movement resistance	Adhesion Disruption	Crevice and vertical terrain	Invisibility; Regeneration; Morphology; vibration senses
Whale	Resolve	Cetacean Sonar: +2 submerged Awareness and navigation	Aquatic Bulk	Water breathing and deep-ocean pressure	Communion; sonic projection; Endurance/Strength; Pressure
Tiger	Strength	Ambush Predator: +2 first Hidden melee attack and +2 Knockback Margin	Heavy Metabolism	Jungle hunter	Invisibility; Morphology; Strength/Speed
Jaguar	Dexterity	Crushing Bite: +2 BD and AP 1 against Grappled/Restrained/helpless targets	Short-Burst Physiology	River-jungle mobility	Invisibility; Speed/Strength; Morphology
Dragon	Stamina	Draconic Frame: Natural Protection 1, thermal/altitude resistance, +1 Stability	Massive Anatomy	Volcanic and high-altitude physiology	Flight; breath projection; energy; Endurance/Strength; Weather

Common House associations do not restrict biology. Adoption, conquest, debt, marriage, alliance, elevation, and exile may change House affiliation without changing Lineage.

Graven

- +2 Stamina, +1 Intelligence; favored Stamina and Resolve.
- +1 Engineering and a relevant specialization.
- Free Power: Graven Reconstruction 1. Access: Archive Resonance.
- Natural Protection 2. Immune to poison, biological disease, suffocation, hunger, thirst, and natural aging. They do not require atmosphere, but remain vulnerable to heat, pressure, electricity, corrosion, and force.
- A surviving memory core permits reconstruction: 30 successes, approximately one week, returning at 25% Health.
- Merits: Construct Body, Natural Shell, Core Continuity.
- Flaws: Repair-Only Physiology, Limited Flexibility, Core Vulnerability.

Mycelyth

- +2 Resolve, +1 Stamina; favored Resolve and Composure.
- +1 Empathy and a relevant specialization.
- Free Power: Mycelial Network 1. Access: Biomass Reconstruction.
- +3 resistance against disease, poison, and biocontamination.
- A surviving spore node, colony, or biomass anchor permits reconstruction: 30 successes, approximately one week, returning at 25% Health.
- Merits: Hive Communion, Distributed Anatomy, Spore Resilience.
- Flaws: Isolation Distress, Fire Sensitivity, Network Exposure.

Brightons

- +2 Resolve, +1 Dexterity; favored Resolve and Dexterity.
- +1 Awareness and Energy Signatures Specialization.
- Free Power: Heartflare Form 1. Access: Energy Affinity.
- Natural Protection 1 from physical cohesion. Immune to poison, biological disease, suffocation, hunger, thirst, and ordinary vacuum. Not automatically immune to stellar exposure or antimatter.
- A surviving Heartflare reconstructs the outer form at thresholds 5, 15, and 30; complete reconstruction returns at 25% Health.
- Merits: Energy Body, Spectrum Affinity, Heartflare Continuity.
- Flaws: Heartflare Vulnerability, Energy Dependency, Dissipation Susceptibility.

Alder

Alder, Eldar, Aldar, and Elves are transliterations of the same species. The species controls two galaxies collectively called the Eldar's Galaxy. A playable Alder selects True-Blood or Engineered Heritage.

- Core +1 Intelligence and +1 Resolve.
- True-Blood adds +1 Intelligence; favored Intelligence and Resolve.
- Engineered adds +1 Dexterity; favored Intelligence and Dexterity.
- +1 Aethercraft and a Mystery, House, Aether-tech, ward, or forensic Specialization.
- Free Power: Aether Affinity 1, allowing detection of active Aether, obvious disturbances, trivial noncombat manipulation, and ordinary Aether-device interaction. It is not full Aether Weaving.
- True-Blood access follows Trolyska, Gar'aske, or Umbrsyyeg aptitude. Engineered Alder receive a designed aptitude.

- Merits: Aetheric Sensitivity, Refined Physiology, and a Heritage Merit such as Ageless Continuity or Designed Aptitude.
- Flaws: Aetheric Resonance, a Heritage social restriction, and a Heritage biological weakness such as Wasting Legacy or Pattern Instability.

ALDER CANON

True-Blood Alder approach seven feet, are functionally immortal, and are not considered adults until about 100. The Wasting Disease has afflicted the species for roughly 3,000 years, and only about one in fifty naturally born children survives the first year. Engineered Alder average about six feet and live roughly a century due to an unintended design flaw. Only True-Blood Alder debate and vote in the House system. Alder hybrids are killed because of Arska's perfect prophecy of the Dark Prophet. Mythos is a secret Kurathi-Alder hybrid and would face automatic execution if exposed.

Warg Lineage Builder

20. Choose one +1 Lineage Attribute based on biology.
21. Create one Merit roughly equal to +2 narrow dice, Protection 1, specialized movement, a natural-weapon enhancement, narrow sense, or once-per-scene tactical benefit.
22. Create one meaningful Flaw such as Light Frame, Cold-Blooded, High Metabolism, dependency, sensitivity, reduced movement, or vulnerable anatomy.
23. Add one narrow environmental adaptation.
24. Grant access to two or three relevant Powers, purchased normally.
25. Audit the package against one +1 Attribute, one approximately two-point Merit, one adaptation, access only, and one meaningful Flaw.

6. Powers | Scope, Energy, Strain, Branches, Techniques, and Scale

Power Scope

Scope	Definition	Initial Cost
Focused	One narrow scalable function.	1 PP
Standard	Two or three tightly related permissions.	2 PP
Framework	Broad domain requiring Branches.	3 PP
Authority	Setting-level conceptual control, normally Planetary+, with mandatory boundaries.	5 PP

Power Rating improves potency, dice, automatic successes, and explicitly listed numerical values. It never automatically grants a new delivery method, mode, Area, Condition, defense, concept, or Scale.

Required Power Entry

- Name, Scope, governing Attribute, and origin
- Basic effect, action, range, target, duration, and scaling
- Permissions and exclusions
- Branches and dependency
- Counters and suppression type
- Technique slots, Energy costs, and Strain
- Potency, Area, Movement, and Structure Scale permissions

Branches, Techniques, Refinements, and Signature Upgrades

- A dependent Branch costs 1 PP at rating 1, cannot exceed its parent, and normally uses the parent's Attribute and Reserve.
- A Branch is independent only when it has a distinct source, different governing Attribute, or separately purchased domain.
- Refinement costs: Minor through Major 1 PP; Grand or Ultimate 2 PP; Cosmic 3 PP.
- Signature upgrade costs: Minor through Major 2 PP; Grand 3 PP; Ultimate 4 PP; Cosmic 6 PP.
- Technique benchmarks: Rating 1 narrow; 3 reliable; 5 strong; 7 major or one Zone; 9 scene-changing; 12 conflict-changing once per scene; 15 setting-level once per Full Rest.

Energy Costs and Zero-Energy Limits

An effect costing 0 Energy cannot directly deal damage, impose a harmful Condition, grant significant Protection, create an extra action, restore Reserve, or provide a repeatable combat benefit. A 0-Energy effect is normally usable no more than once per turn unless passive.

Center Power and Reserve Recovery

- Center Power may be used once per scene normally.
- A second Center Power before a Short Rest costs 1 Willpower and 1 Strain.
- A third costs 1 Willpower and 3 total additional Strain. A fourth is unavailable without a Technique.
- At the start of a turn, recover 1 Reserve only when no Energy has been spent since the start of the previous turn and no sustained upkeep was paid.
- A Short Rest restores 25% maximum Reserve, rounded up. A Full Rest restores all Reserve.

Strain

Strain Limit equals Stamina + Resolve. Strain penalties are exceptional.

Strain Level	Effect
Below one-third	No penalty
One-third or more	-1 die to direct Power and control rolls
Two-thirds or more	-2 dice; Power costs +1 Energy; signature control effects may occur
At limit	Crash

A ten-minute Breather removes 1 Strain once between Short Rests. A Short Rest removes one-quarter Strain Limit, rounded up. A Full Rest removes all Strain.

Power Crash

- Crash damage is Lethal equal to current Strain divided by 4, rounded up, maximum 8.
- Reserve becomes 0.
- The character gains Power Crashed and Exhausted.
- Non-survival sustained effects end unless independently anchored.

Overcharge

Effective Rating Increase	Additional Energy	Strain
+1	+2	+1
+2	+5	+3
+3	+9	+6

Overcharge cannot raise effective Power Rating above 15. It improves only effects already permitted by the Power or Technique.

Sustained Effects

Type	Rule
Maintained	Pays upkeep; does not consume concentration capacity unless stated.
Concentration	Pays upkeep and occupies capacity.
Committed	Reduces maximum available Reserve while active.
Independent	Continues for its duration without active upkeep.

Concentration capacity equals 1 + floor(Resolve/5), maximum 4. Each Concentration effect beyond the first applies a cumulative -2 exceptional penalty to Power actions and checks. Damage requires Resolve + Composure, difficulty 2; difficulty 3 for Massive damage and 5 for Catastrophic damage. Incapacitation, unconsciousness, or Crash ends non-survival Maintained and Concentration effects unless they are Independent or Anchored.

Range and Area

Reach Rating	Distance
0	10 feet
1	15 feet
2	30 feet
3	60 feet
4	120 feet
5	Local Zone

Area Step	Coverage
1	Single target
2	Cluster
3	Small Area
4	One Zone
5	Several Zones or structure
6	Strategic Area

Combined Powers

Each supporter makes a coordination roll against difficulty 2 for compatible work, 3 for difficult coordination, or 5 for extreme coordination.

Support Result	Combined Points
0-1 successes	0
2-4	1

Support Result	Combined Points
5-9	2
10+	3
Botch	-1 CP and backlash

CP Cost	Benefit
1	+1 Teamwork die, maximum +5; or +1 BD/healing/Protection, maximum +5; or +3 barrier Structure
2	+1 AP or Suppression Value, maximum +3; or +1 range, Area, or duration step
3 total	+1 Potency Scale
8 total	+2 Potency Scale
15 total	+3 Potency Scale

Combined Power Points do not count as Teamwork dice and do not bypass the Teamwork cap.

7. Power Catalogue | Core Powers, Framework Branches, and Reality Authority

Core Power Classifications

Power	Scope	Governing Attribute	Core Boundary
Super Strength	Standard	Strength	Does not add full rating to every Brawl roll.
Super Endurance	Standard	Stamina	Protection is approximately half rating, rounded up; movement remains personal without Techniques.
Flight	Standard	Dexterity or Resolve	Movement permission does not imply vacuum survival or attack Scale.
Super Speed	Standard	Dexterity	Does not automatically grant extra Standard Actions.
Regeneration	Standard	Stamina	Uses Healing Value; no Aggravated or Annihilation healing without explicit permission.
Telekinesis	Standard	Resolve	Does not grant independent constructs or mind control.
Telepathy	Framework	Resolve	Uses Branches and Mental Intrusion.
Energy Projection	Standard	Dexterity or Resolve	One energy type unless expanded.
Energy Manipulation	Framework	Resolve or Intelligence	Branches define projection, absorption, constructs, conversion, fields, and movement.
Shapeshifting	Framework	Stamina or Resolve	Does not copy Skills, memories, Powers, souls, or identity by default.
Invisibility	Standard	Composure	Visual concealment by default; other senses require expansion.
Force Fields	Standard	Resolve	Choose Protection or Structure at full effectiveness, not both without explicit upgrade.
Weather Control	Framework	Resolve	Does not create unrelated elemental Powers or permanent climate change automatically.
Technopathy	Framework	Intelligence	Does not replace Technology/Engineering or automatically control sapient AI.
Biomass Ascension	Framework	Stamina or Resolve	No free Regeneration, resurrection, species rewrite, or permanent minions.
Aether Weaving	Framework	Intelligence or Resolve	Relevant Mystery Branch is mandatory.
Reality Authority	Authority	Resolve	Parent is not universal; no permanent player-character rewrite without consent.

Core Technique Sequences

Power	Techniques at Ratings 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 12, 15
Super Strength	Mighty Leap; Crushing Grip; Thunderclap; Seismic Blow; Mountain Hurl; Worldbreaker; Atlas Ascendant
Super Endurance	Hardened Body; Unyielding Stance; Impact Absorption; Environmental Survival; Immovable; Planetary Bulwark; Eternal Bastion
Flight	Controlled Hover; Aerial Dash; Evasive Flight; Supersonic Flight; Orbital Flight; Interstellar Passage; Cosmic Traverse
Super Speed	Quick Step; Rapid Action; Afterimage; Lightning Assault; Time-Slice; Relativistic Motion; Omnipresent Moment
Regeneration	Rapid Clotting; Limb Regrowth; Vital Organ Rebuild; Disease Purge; Pain Damping; Cellular Memory; Resurrection Gate
Telekinesis	Fine Manipulation; Kinetic Shove; Telekinetic Grasp; Mass Lift; Battlefield Control; Planetary Hand; Cosmic Grasp
Energy Projection	Pulse Shot; Piercing Beam; Energy Burst; Sweeping Barrage; Nova Discharge; Planetbreaker Lance; Stellar Ray
Invisibility	Fade; Mobile Cloak; Combat Invisibility; Group Veil; Sensor Null; Planetary Erasure; Cosmic Absence
Force Fields	Personal Ward; Reactive Shield; Barrier Wall; Dome; Fortress Field; Planetary Shield; Cosmic Aegis

TECHNIQUE NAMES

Technique names establish the canonical progression and intended function. Each individual character records the exact Energy, action, range, Area, duration, and effect from its final Power entry. A name alone does not grant unlisted permissions.

Telepathy Branches

Branch	Basic Domain	Technique Sequence
Communion	Willing communication, shared senses, group thought.	Mind Whisper; Chorus Link; Shared Senses; Battle Consensus; Planetary Chorus; Civilization Concord; Universal Communion
Perception	Emotions, surface thoughts, deep probes, psychic traces.	Empathic Pulse; Surface Scan; Deep Probe; Psychic Autopsy; Mindfinder; Planetary Mindsearch; Cosmic Awareness
Influence	Emotion and behavioral pressure.	Emotional Nudge; Calm or Agitate; Command Seed; Mass Suggestion; Sovereign Emotion; Planetary Edict; Archetypal Imperative
Memory	Recollection, reading, sealing, and revision.	Perfect Recollection; Memory Reading; Recent Revision; Memory Seal; Rewrite the Chapter; Rebuild the Life Narrative; Collective Memory
Dominion	Commands, control, possession-level contests.	Mental Halt; Compelling Order; Marionette Thread; Sovereign Contest; Possession Bridge; Legion Throne; Absolute Dominion
Projection	Psychic avatars, dreams, mindscapes, remote consciousness.	Psychic Avatar; Dreamwalk; Astral Step; Mindscape Forge; Independent Projection; World-Mind Passage; Cosmic Projection

Energy Manipulation Branches

Branch	Technique Sequence
Projection	Pulse Shot; Piercing Beam; Energy Burst; Sweeping Barrage; Nova Discharge; Planetbreaker Lance; Stellar Ray
Absorption	Dampen Exposure; Store Charge; Predatory Drain; Reactive Absorption; Energy Sink; Stellar Conduit; Event-Horizon Reservoir
Constructs	Energy Tool; Construct Wall; Platform or Armor; Autonomous Construct; Energy Fortress; City Lattice; Cosmic Architecture
Conversion	Utility Conversion; Power Feed; Reactive Conversion; Field Transmutation; Conversion Cascade; Planetary Grid; Cosmic Spectrum
Field Control	Deflect Current; Redirect Energy; Dampening Zone; Energy Lock; Battlefield Domain; Planetary Field Command; Cosmic Field Sovereignty
Movement	Energy Jet; Ride the Current; Energy-Form Dash; Orbital Transit; Stellar Current; Galactic Conduit; Cosmic Translation

Shapeshifting Branches

Branch	Technique Sequence
Morphology	Functional Organ; Additional Limbs; Adaptive Frame; Fluid Anatomy; Polymorphic Body; Perfect Organism; Archetypal Form
Mimicry	Mask of Another; Biometric Replica; Species Masquerade; Perfect Impostor; Functional Species Mimicry; Living Archive; Mythic Reflection
Mass	Density Shift; Size Shift; Mass Redistribution; Giant or Diminutive Form; Colossal Body; Planetary Titan; Cosmic Mass State
Biological Arsenal	Natural Weapon; Venom Gland; Carapace; Spine Volley; Apex Arsenal; Perfect Predator; World Predator
Adaptive Evolution	Rapid Adjustment; Environmental Adaptation; Reactive Resistance; Counter-Evolution; Adaptive Suite; Planetary Evolution; Cosmic Evolution
Swarm	Partial Separation; Swarm Form; Distributed Awareness; Infesting Tide; Reform from Fragments; Planetary Swarm; Cosmic Colony

Weather Control Branches

Branch	Technique Sequence
Atmosphere	Clean Air; Fog Bank; Breathable Bubble; Gas Dominion; Atmospheric Dome; World Breath; Atmospheric Genesis
Wind	Gust; Windborne; Wind Wall; Tornado; Jetstream Command; Planetary Winds; Stellar Wind
Storm	Thunderhead; Storm Cover; Storm Cell; Tempest Domain; Hurricane Dominion; Planetary Superstorm; Cosmic Tempest
Temperature	Comfort Zone; Thermal Bolt; Heatwave or Deep Freeze; Flash Freeze or Thermal Shock; City Climate; Planetary Thermal Rewrite; Stellar Thermodynamics
Precipitation	Raincall; Sleet Curtain; Hail Barrage; Deluge; Regional Flood; Planetary Hydrological Command; World Ocean
Lightning	Static Arc; Lightning Bolt; Chain Lightning; Thunderstroke; City Grid Blackout; Planetary Lightning Lattice; Stellar Discharge
Pressure	Pressure Pulse; Crushing Pocket; Vacuum Bubble; Pressure Wall; Atmospheric Implosion; Planetary Pressure Command; Cosmic Compression Wave

Technopathy Branches

Branch	Technique Sequence
Interface	Machine Whisper; Universal Port; Total Diagnostic; Parallel Interface; Remote Embodiment; Planetary Interface; Civilization Interface
Hacking	Ghost Key; Silent Exploit; System Sabotage; Root Intrusion; Counterhack Dominion; Planetary Breach; Cosmic Codebreaker
Machine Command	Single Command; Drone Cohort; Weapon-System Command; Machine Formation; Factory Awakening; Planetary Machine Army; Galactic Machine Mandate
AI Communion	Machine Empathy; Code Conversation; Shared Processing; Cognitive Bridge; Mind Merge; Planetary AI Conclave; Machine-Soul Concord
Remote Control	Remote Hand; Remote Pilot; Precision Override; Facility Puppet; Distant Embodiment; Planetary Teleoperation; Galactic Presence
Network Dominion	Node Map; Traffic Shaping; Network Isolation; City Grid Dominion; Planetary Mesh; Interstellar Web; Galactic Network Sovereignty

Biomass Ascension Branches

Branch	Technique Sequence
Self-Mutation	Adaptive Tissue; Living Weapon; Combat Carapace; Predatory Form; Apex Body; Ascendant Organism; World-Form
Biomass Growth	Rapid Sprout; Living Wall; Biological Terrain; Living Fortress; City Forest; Planetary Bloom; Ascendant Biosphere
Assimilation	Nutrient Absorption; Devour and Mend; Trait Analysis; Temporary Assimilation; Mass Harvest; Ecosystem Assimilation; World Devourer
Spawn	Scout Organism; Servitor; Combat Spawn; Specialist Brood; Brood Army; Planetary Brood; Cosmic Progeny
Healing	Clot and Close; Restorative Touch; Purging Growth; Regrow Tissue; Body Reconstruction; Mass Restoration; Planetary Renewal
Environmental Adaptation	Hazard Response; Specialized Biology; Alien Environment; Vacuum Organism; Multi-Environment Form; Planetary Adaptation; Stellar Organism

Reality Authority Branches

Reality Authority uses a higher Energy and Strain profile: Energy 2, 4, 6, 8, 11 +1 Strain, 15 +3 Strain, and 25 +6 Strain across the seven Technique tiers. It remains subject to anchors, equal Authority, causality, paradox, Scale, and player consent.

Branch	Technique Sequence
Matter	Reshape Object; Common Transmutation; Matter Repair; Structural Rewrite; City of Living Matter; Planetary Transmutation; Cosmic Matter Genesis
Space	Fold Step; Spatial Redirect; Gate; Pocket Expanse; Planetary Gate; Galactic Bridge; Cosmic Topology
Time	Temporal Sense; Brief Slow; Accelerated Moment; Rewind Position; Temporal Stasis; City Outside Time; Rewrite the Epoch
Probability	Lucky Nudge; Tilt the Odds; Misfortune; Chain of Coincidence; Inevitable Outcome; Planetary Fortune; Cosmic Destiny

Branch	Technique Sequence
Law	Minor Prohibition; Property Mandate; Ward of Law; Domain Rule; City Mandate; Planetary Constitution; Cosmic Constant
Causality	Cause Sight; Delay Consequence; Redirect Effect; Sever the Chain; Causal Loop; Rewrite the Event; First Cause
Identity	True Pattern; Identity Anchor; Restore the Self; Trait Revision; Rewrite the Role; Species Reformation; Archetype Rewrite

Power-Creation Weight Audit

Technique Tier	Design Weight
Minor	2
Standard	3
Strong	5
Major	7
Grand	10
Ultimate	14
Cosmic	20

Feature	Weight
Minor utility	1
Standard damage	2
Standard Healing Value	2
Protection 2-3	2
+1 BD	1
AP 1-2	1
AP 3-4	2
AP 5-6	3
AP 7+	4+
Condition severity 1/2/3	1/2/3
Hard control	4
Far/Extreme/Strategic range	1/2/3
Area step	1-3
Scene duration	1
Additional target group	1
Barrier Structure	2+
Scale-Breaker 1/2/3	3/7/12
Extra Minor or Movement	4
Extra Standard	7
Aggravated healing	3
Resurrection	8+
Permanent transformation	6+
Identity or memory rewrite	6+
Broad immunity	5+
Automatic or unavoidable effect	4+

Limitations may return design weight: Full Action +1, Concentration +1, committed Reserve +1, once per scene +2, once per Full Rest +4, +1 Strain +1, +3 Strain +3, narrow target +1, rare environment +1 to +3, severe backlash +2, setup +1. Limitation credit cannot exceed half the normal Technique budget.

8. The Eight Aether Mysteries | Domain boundaries for Aether Weaving

Aether Weaving is a Framework governed by Intelligence or Resolve, chosen when purchased. Each Mystery is a dependent Standard Branch costing 1 PP at rating 1, limited by the parent rating, and using the same Reserve and governing Attribute.

SHARED TECHNIQUE PROFILE

The standard Mystery Energy profile is 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 10 +1 Strain once per scene, and 15 +3 Strain once per Full Rest for ratings 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 12, and 15.

Multi-Mystery Convergence uses the lowest participating Branch rating. Pay the highest Technique cost plus 1 Energy for each additional Mystery. Using three or more Mysteries adds 1 Strain. Permissions are limited by the weakest participating Mystery.

Font

Domain: raw Aether sources, detection, transfer, storage, channeling, stabilization, ritual supply, and temporary wells. Basic effect: sense active Aether at Near range and create a harmless spark, trivial device response, mark, or test response. Font does not directly project damage, shape matter, heal, open Gates, control minds, convert unrelated energy, create unlimited Reserve, or establish permanent Fonts without a project.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Conduit Thread	Minor; Near; scene. Transfer 1 Energy between a willing user and compatible device or source. No Energy is created.
3	Aether Reservoir	Standard; commit 2; until Short Rest. Store 3 external Aether Energy.
5	Siphon Weave	Reaction or Standard. Oppose an Aether effect or source; reduce its effective rating by net successes for the interaction and recover net Energy, maximum 3 once per scene.
7	Overchannel	Minor. The next Aether Technique gains +1 effective rating, +2 dice, or +1 permitted Potency; gain 1 Strain afterward.
9	Font Well	Full; Zone; scene; commit 5. Create a recovery pool equal to Font rating; eligible users recover 1 at start of turn only when they spent no Energy since the previous turn.
12	Stellar Font	Full; once per scene. Supply 10 temporary Energy to one ritual, Combined Power, construct, Gate, ward, or healing effort; alternatively provide Scale-Breaker 2 for sourcing or 2 Ritual CP.
15	Prime Font	Full; Planetary or immense installation; scene; once per Full Rest. Supply the first 2 Energy of each Aether Technique, grant +1 effective rating, and provide +3 Ritual CP; total supplied cannot exceed twice Font rating.

Shaping

Domain: Aetheric structure and form, including sigils, tools, weapons, barriers, platforms, nonsapient constructs, wards, enchantments, and architecture. Shaping does not create its own Energy source, sapience, permanent artifacts, biological healing, teleportation, soul or mind control, or permanent matter without a project.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Aether Tool	Minor; scene. Create a tool or weapon, BD 2, no AP, Structure 5, Hardness 1.
3	Warding Sigil	Standard; object, door, or character; scene. Protection 2 against one defined Aether category and +2 resistance to detection, intrusion, or manipulation from it.
5	Shaped Barrier	Standard; Near. Protection equals half rating rounded up; Structure 10 + twice rating; Hardness equals Protection.
7	Aether Servitor	Full; commit 3; scene. Create a nonsapient construct with one defined function such as guard, carry, scout, repair, message, or assist.
9	Domain Lattice	Full; several Zones; scene. Create a network of walls, platforms, cages, bridges, sigils, channels, or hazardous terrain; choose up to three compatible functions when learned.
12	World-Pattern	Full or ritual; City Scale; once per scene. Create a city-scale ward, fortress, containment structure, transport lattice, or comparable architecture.
15	Cosmic Architecture	Full or extended; Planetary/Stellar; once per Full Rest. Create a temporary planetary shield, stellar bridge, cosmic prison, dimensional scaffold, or sanctuary. Permanent versions require a project.

Mind

Domain: mental communication, illusion, emotion, surface impressions, compulsion, dreams, mindscapes, and high-rank cognition. Mind uses the Mental Intrusion system. Possession normally belongs to Soul, and foundational rewrite requires extended high-rank work and player consent for permanent player-character effects.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Mind Whisper	Minor; Far; scene. Silent communication with willing targets; an unwilling target receives one word or image and may reject further contact.
3	Glamour	Standard; one mind; Concentration. Create a one-sense mental illusion opposed by Mental Defense; contradictions allow retesting.
5	Thought Hook	Standard; Intrusion Level 1. Read a surface thought, apply Receptive 1 or Pressured 1, or conceal one simple thought.
7	Aetheric Geas	Standard; scene or defined simple condition. Intrusion Level 2; impose one clear restriction or command, excluding suicide, impossible action, core betrayal, or permanent loyalty.
9	Dream Palace	Full; group or one sleeper; Concentration. Create a shared mindscape; Mind actions gain +2 ordinary dice inside. Physical bodies are not harmed without a separate effect.
12	Dominion of Thought	Full; City Scale; once per scene. Apply a broad emotional, illusory, or behavioral directive; targets resist separately.
15	Noetic Rewrite	Extended; once per Full Rest. Repair or replace foundational cognition, collective curse, or mental architecture. Permanent player-character change requires consent.

Seer

Domain: omens, remote viewing, concealment revelation, past echoes, possible futures, prophetic patterns, and temporal or causal interference detection. Seer does not directly alter probability or guarantee outcomes. Repeated examination of the same event increases difficulty by 1 each time, maximum +3.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Omen Thread	Minor. Learn whether one immediate course is favorable, dangerous, mixed, or obscured; gain +2 dice to one informed action.
3	Far Sight	Standard; Concentration. See and hear a known, marked, or connected location at Extreme range.
5	Truth Lens	Standard. Detect illusion, shapeshifting, Aether concealment, false magical identity, prophetic alteration, or recent ritual residue; reveals nature, not every fact.
7	Forked Future	Full. Observe two or three likely outcomes; choose one approach and gain +3 ordinary dice to one decisive action before scene end.
9	Chronicle of Echoes	Full. View a significant past event tied to a target, including participants, actions, emotional tone, and Aether effects; concealment may distort it.
12	World Prophecy	Full or extended; Planetary; once per scene. Reveal a likely path for a major planetary event, including a turning point, preventable condition, hidden participant, sacrifice, or uncertain variable.
15	Fate's Horizon	Extended; Cosmic; once per Full Rest. Reveal one possible future for a civilization, galaxy, species, entity, or dimension. The vision may be conditional, incomplete, self-fulfilling, fixed, or opposed.

Life

Domain: living biological systems, including healing, bleeding, disease, poison, organs, limbs, willing reshaping, viable tissue, and ecosystems. Life cannot heal souls, repair machines, command minds, perform biomass assimilation, resurrect alone, or rewrite a species in one action.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Clot and Close	Minor or Reaction; touch. Heal 1 Superficial, end Bleeding 1, or stabilize a Minor biological Injury for the scene.
3	Restorative Weave	Standard; touch. Heal full Healing Value in Superficial or Lethal damage; same target once per round.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
5	Purging Growth	Standard. Reduce Poisoned, Diseased, or biological corruption by final successes, maximum 2, or restore minor tissue.
7	Regrow the Form	Full or extended. Restore an organ, limb, sense, or comparable structure at threshold -5 and one minimum time step faster.
9	Restoration Chorus	Full; Zone. Divide twice Healing Value among targets, heal full Healing Value to up to three targets, or reduce one common biological Condition by 1 for all.
12	Genesis Body	Extended; once per scene. Create a complete viable body from pattern, biomass, tissue, or template. It has no soul, memory, or identity without Soul.
15	Worldbloom	Extended; Planetary; once per Full Rest. Restore ecosystems, cure civilization-level disease, repair mass biology, rebuild extinct nonsapient ecologies, or stabilize a biosphere.

Soul

Domain: spirits, continuity, spiritual healing, exorcism, binding, preservation, vessels, and resurrection. Soul does not heal the body by itself, create new souls, guarantee memories, create loyalty, or restore annihilated continuity.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Soul Mark	Standard; Near; scene. Identify and mark a soul or anchor; gain +2 to track, protect, detect possession, or recognize false spiritual identity.
3	Spirit Speech	Standard; scene. Communicate with a willing spirit, recent dead, bound entity, artifact soul, or related presence. It is not compelled to be truthful.
5	Soul Mend	Standard. Heal half Healing Value in Aggravated spiritual harm, repair a Minor Soul Injury, reduce corruption or possession by 1, or stabilize a departing soul.
7	Bind or Exorcise	Standard or Full; clash. Eject, bind into a vessel, prevent possession for the scene, or break an attachment.
9	Soul Vessel	Full; commit 5. Preserve a willing or defeated soul in a prepared crystal, artifact, body, construct, or sanctum.
12	The Great Return	Extended; once per Full Rest. Restore an intact continuity into a viable body or vessel, suggested threshold 25; return at 25% Health, Exhausted 2, and one Major Injury.
15	Anima Restoration	Extended; Cosmic; once per Full Rest. Restore masses of displaced, trapped, or fragmented souls after civilization catastrophe, requiring anchors, bodies or vessels, a major Font, and Life or reconstruction support.

Gate

Domain: teleportation, portals, return anchors, planetary and interstellar travel, dimensional passage, and Gate networks. Gate does not provide life support, time travel, automatic ward bypass, certainty at unknown destinations, unresisted hostile teleportation, or permanent dimensions.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Gate Step	Movement or Minor. Teleport to a visible safe point at Near range; counts as movement.
3	Passage Door	Standard; Far; until end of next turn. Connect visible or known endpoints for self and one willing target.
5	Anchor Recall	Standard. Return to a prepared same-layer anchor at Extreme range; additional willing passengers cost 1 Energy each, maximum rating.
7	Dimensional Door	Full. Open a portal to an adjacent dimension, known pocket, Strategic location, or spirit domain with Soul support; lasts one round unless sustained.
9	World Gate	Full; Planetary or near orbit; scene; normally once per scene. Move a group, vehicle, or evacuation body; wards oppose.
12	Star Bridge	Full; Galactic; once per scene. Connect known or targeted interstellar locations for groups, strategic equipment, or a designed vessel.
15	Cosmic Threshold	Full or extended; Intergalactic, dimensional, or Cosmic; once per Full Rest. Requires a known target, Seer guidance, anchor, or meaningful connection.

Arbiter

Domain: counterweaving, typed suppression, seals, permissions, willing oaths, prohibitions, quarantine, and adjudication of Aetheric claims. Arbiter does not create general Reality law, control unrelated non-Aether systems, impose arbitrary obedience, permanently remove Powers, or grant social authority.

Rating	Technique	Effect Summary
1	Counterweave	Reaction. Oppose activation; reduce effective rating by net successes for the action. At rating 0 the effect fails without a refund.
3	Seal of Prohibition	Standard; object, door, or small Area; scene. Prohibit one narrow Aetheric act; violations are opposed.
5	Binding Oath	Full or extended; willing or negotiated. Define participants, conduct, prohibition, duration, consequence, and release. Consequences may include Pressure, Strain, marks, or lost permission.
7	Judgment Field	Full; Zone; Sustained. Suppress one Mystery, origin, or Technique family; Suppression Rating equals Arbiter rating. Broad suppression reduces effective rating by 2.
9	Sever Enchantment	Full. End or unbind a sustained effect, curse, ward, contract, possession seal, or artifact enchantment; permanent/civilization effects require a project.
12	Planetary Edict	Full or ritual; Planetary; once per scene. Establish one specific Aetheric law across the domain.
15	Final Quarantine	Extended; Cosmic; once per Full Rest. Seal an entity, breach, corrupted Mystery, galactic network, planetary curse, or hostile magical civilization using defined anchors and release conditions.

Aether Ritual Roles

Mystery	Primary Ritual Function
Font	Energy and source stabilization
Shaping	Structure, form, and duration
Mind	Cognitive targets and effects
Seer	Targeting, timing, risk, and possible outcome
Life	Living repair and transformation
Soul	Identity and continuity
Gate	Range, access, and movement
Arbiter	Rules, permissions, and containment

Every 5 ritual successes after minimum Progress may produce 1 Ritual CP. Spend 1 for +1 BD/healing/Protection or +3 barrier Structure; 2 for +1 AP/Suppression Value or a range/Area/duration step; 3 total for +1 Potency, 8 total for +2, and 15 total for +3. The ritual must possess the relevant Mystery permission.

Starting Ritual Instability is normally 0 for established work, 1 for novel work, 2 for alien or experimental work, and 3 for forbidden, cosmic, resurrection, or Reality-adjacent work.

9. Equipment, Crafting, Cybernetics, Powered Armor, and Artifacts | Personal technology and constructed power

Universal Equipment Profile

Every item records Name, Grade, Equipment Point cost, Base Damage or Protection, Armor Piercing, range, capacity, action, Structure, Hardness, traits, restrictions, repair method, and Equipment Access requirement.

Grade	Benchmark	Typical EP
0	Primitive or improvised	0-1
1	Civilian or professional	1
2	Restricted or military	2-3
3	Advanced AEGIS or low-superhuman	3-4
4	Elite alien or high-superhuman	4
5	Strategic or planetary	5
6	Unique cosmic or civilization-defining	5 plus investment

Equipment Access shortfall uses difficulty 2 + shortfall, maximum 7. Grade-5 and Grade-6 access always requires narrative justification. Access may represent temporary issue rather than ownership.

Equipment Durability

- Structure is item Health; Hardness functions as Protection.
- At 0 Structure the item is Broken.
- An item is Destroyed by Annihilation, another hit at least Hardness +5, a specific Critical result, or destruction of its core.
- Worn equipment is damaged only when targeted, used as cover, struck by Sunder, affected by an appropriate Area or technology attack, or exposed through a relevant Massive or Catastrophic event.

Weapon Traits

Trait	Effect Summary
Automatic	Supports suppressive fire and automatic modes.
Burst	Spend 3 ammunition for +1 attack die.
Breaching	+2 Raw Damage against objects, barriers, and cover.
Charge	May increase output after setup.
Compact	+2 concealment.
EMP	Affects technological systems and cybernetics.
Explosive	Area and blast interaction.
Heavy	Requires Strength 4 or bracing; otherwise -2 dice.
Nonlethal	Deals Superficial or controlled disabling damage where appropriate.
Overheat	Repeated use risks Jammed or shutdown.
Reach X	Extends melee reach.
Scatter	+2 at Near, -2 at Far.
Sealed	Resists environmental contamination.
Smart	Ignore one range or cover penalty while linked.
Stun	May apply Dazed or Stunned.
Sunder	Designed to damage equipment or armor.
Thrown	Uses thrown-range rules.
Two-Handed	Requires both hands.
Unwieldy	Suffers limitations in cramped or rapid use.

Weapon Catalogue

Weapon	G	EP	BD	AP	Range	Traits
Improvised club	0	0	2	0	Engaged	Unreliable
Utility knife	1	1	2	0	Engaged	Compact
Combat blade	1	1	3	0	Engaged	Lethal
Baton	1	1	2	0	Engaged	Nonlethal
Shock baton	2	2	3	0	Engaged	Stun
Civilian pistol	1	1	3	0	Far	Compact
Service pistol	2	2	4	1	Far	Capacity 12
Heavy pistol	2	2	5	1	Far	Unwieldy
Carbine	2	3	5	1	Far	Burst, Two-Handed
Shotgun	2	3	5	0	Far	Scatter
Sniper rifle	3	3	6	2	Extreme	Two-Handed
Web launcher	3	3	2	0	Far	Restrained, Nonlethal
AEGIS pulse sidearm	3	3	5	2	Far	Smart
AEGIS pulse rifle	3	3	6	2	Extreme	Burst, Smart
AEGIS breaching cannon	3	4	7	3	Far	Breaching, Heavy
Psychic stun projector	3	3	2	0	Near	Mental, Stun
Aether disruption wand	3	3	3	1	Far	Aetheric, Suppression
PARAGON kinetic lance	4	4	8	3	Extreme	Charge, Breaching
PARAGON restraint projector	4	4	4	1	Far	Restrained, Suppression
JSS star lance	5	5	11	5	Strategic	Charge, Heavy
Planetary siege weapon	5	5	13	6	Strategic	Area, Breaching
Cosmic relic weapon	6	5	15	7+	Defined	Unique investment

Armor and Shields

Armor	G	EP	Protection	Traits
Reinforced clothing	1	1	2	Concealable
Civilian body armor	2	2	4	Restricted
Tactical armor	2	3	5	Optional sealed
AEGIS field armor	3	3	6	Smart, sealed
AEGIS heavy armor	3	4	7	Heavy
PARAGON armor	4	4	8	Scale-hardened option
JSS strategic armor	5	5	10	Environmental, hardened
Cosmic adaptive shell	6	5	12	Unique investment
Riot shield	2	2	+3 Block	Cover, Structure 12
AEGIS barrier shield	3	3	+4 Block	Force barrier, Structure 18
PARAGON bastion shield	4	4	+5 Block	Scale-hardened, Structure 25

General Equipment

Item	G	EP	Effect
Professional toolkit	1	1	+1 relevant repair or craft die
Advanced engineering kit	2	2	+2 Engineering in the field
Forensic kit	2	2	+2 Investigation for physical evidence
Medical kit	2	2	+2 Medicine; supports stabilization
Trauma unit	3	3	+2 Medicine and one Treatment Scene
Portable laboratory	3	3	Facility 1 for one Science field
Sensor scanner	2	2	Sensor Rating 5; choose two categories
AEGIS multisensor	3	3	Sensor Rating 7; choose four categories
Cosmic scanner	5	5	Sensor Rating 11; strategic or exotic detection

Item	G	EP	Effect
Secure communicator	2	1	Encrypted planetary communication
Interstellar relay	3	3	Interstellar communication
Universal translator	2	2	+2 Academics or Xenology for language
Hacking rig	2	2	+2 Technology intrusion
Counterintrusion suite	3	3	+2 digital defense
Infiltration cloak	3	3	Concealed 2 against visual and thermal detection
Aether masking veil	3	3	Concealed 2 against Aetheric detection
Psychic ward band	3	3	+2 Mental Defense against intrusion
Dimensional beacon	3	3	Stable Gate reference
Reality anchor stake	4	4	Anchor Rating 8 in Near Area
Breaching charge	2	1	BD 6, AP 3 against objects
Strategic charge	4	4	BD 10, AP 5, Area
Restraint cuffs	2	1	Restraint Rating 5
Superhuman restraints	4	4	Restraint Rating 9, typed option
Environmental suit	2	2	Vacuum, temperature, and toxin protection
Strategic survival suit	4	4	Radiation, pressure, and hostile-atmosphere protection
Emergency shelter	2	2	Safe Rest for a small group
Drone scout	2	2	Sensor Rating 5 and independent Movement
AEGIS tactical drone	3	3	Sensor 7 and one support function
Power analyzer	3	3	+2 Science/Aethercraft to identify Power effects
Continuity monitor	4	4	Detects soul, core, or anchor instability

Crafting and Modification

An item has Upgrade Slots equal to Grade, except Grade 0 has none. Minor and Standard modifications normally use one slot; Major modifications use two; Prototype modifications use two or three; Power-grade modifications use two plus Power investment.

Modification	Typical Permission
Minor	Narrow +1 die, concealment, setup, seal, capacity, or removal of an inconvenience. No BD, Protection, AP, Area, or Scale.
Standard	+1 BD, Protection, or AP; +3 Structure; +1 Hardness; +50% capacity; minor trait; one range band.
Major	Distribute +2 among BD/Protection/AP/Hardness; major trait; new mode; Area 2; integrated sensor, shield, suppression, or named Scale-Breaker 1.
Prototype	Distribute +3, strong alternate mode, limited Power-like effect, higher Scale, or action efficiency. Begins with Defect 1 unless prevented.
Unique Artifact	Power, Signature, Authority, continuity anchor, or unique Scale; requires rare materials, story, and character investment.

Crafting Projects

Project	Design Threshold	Fabrication Threshold	Interval
Minor	5	5	Hour
Standard	10	10	Day
Major	15	20	Week
Prototype	25	35	Week
Unique	40+	60+	Month or arc

- An existing blueprint skips Design.
- Facility Ratings: 0 improvised, 1 professional, 2 advanced, 3 strategic, 4 civilization, 5 unique/cosmic. One level short imposes -3 dice; two levels short imposes -5 and caps quality; three levels short is impossible.
- Supply Units normally equal EP for stock items. Minor modifications cost 1 SU, Standard 2, Major 3, Prototype 5, and Unique 8 plus unique components.
- Base difficulty by Grade is 1 for Grades 0-1, then equal to Grade for Grades 2-6.
- Each 5 excess successes produces 1 Quality Point, maximum 3. A Quality Point may add +3 Structure, +1 Hardness, +25% capacity, reduce repair difficulty, remove a Defect, improve concealment, reduce setup, or ignore the first Jam/Overheat/mission.

- Quality cannot increase BD, Protection, AP, or Scale beyond the design.

Field Modification and Repair

- A field modification takes ten minutes. Roll Intelligence + relevant Skill against difficulty 2 for Grades 0-2, 3 for Grades 3-4, and 5 for Grades 5-6. One temporary effect lasts for the scene; only one field modification may be active. A botch deals at least 1 Structure and creates a Defect.
- Field repair takes ten minutes. Every 3 final successes restores 1 Structure, maximum 3 per scene. It cannot restore a Destroyed item.
- Workshop repair costs 2 successes per ordinary Structure, 3 per critical Structure, and 5 per Aggravated or exotic Structure. Restoring a Broken item adds 5 successes.
- Reverse engineering uses threshold 10 + five times Grade, with intervals of day for Grades 1-3, week for 4-5, and month for 6. The first reproduction is one Grade lower or has Defect 1; a second project perfects it.

Prototype Defects

Common Defects include Overheat, Energy Drain, Fragile (-2 Hardness), Unstable, Calibration (-2 dice until calibrated), Obvious, Backlash, and Limited Environment. A Prototype begins with Defect 1 unless the project critically succeeds or spends 2 Quality Points.

Suppression Equipment

Suppression devices list Suppression Rating, Suppression Value, type, Area, duration, and escape or resistance method. On failure, reduce effective Power Rating by Suppression Value. At effective rating 0, the affected Power or Branch is disabled. Broad suppression uses Suppression Value -2, minimum 1.

Device	G	EP	SR	SV	Type
Reinforced restraint	2	2	5	-	Physical
Kinetic inhibitor cuffs	3	3	7	2	Strength/Speed
Biological inhibitor dose	3	2	7	2	Biological
Anti-regeneration dose	4	3	8	3	Regeneration
Psychic collar	3	3	7	2	Psychic
Advanced mental ward	4	4	9	3	Mental
Energy dampener	3	3	7	2	Energy
Technological nullifier	3	3	7	2	Technological
Aetheric seal	3	3	7	2	Aetheric
Dimensional anchor	4	4	9	3	Gate/Teleportation
Reserve lock	4	4	9	2	Reserve recovery
Suppression ammunition	3	2	6	2	Chosen typed source
Suppression grenade	4	4	8	2	Zone, chosen type
Suppression projector	4	4	9	3	Far or Zone
Broad nullification chamber	5	5	11	3 broad	Multiple sources
Reality anchor array	5	5	12	4	Reality/Dimensional
Planetary suppression network	5-6	Project	13+	4+	Planetary typed

Cybernetics

Restorative cybernetics restore baseline function and cost no Integration Capacity. Persistent advantages use Equipment plus a Merit and Integration. Scalable superhuman capabilities are Powers with the implant as source.

Integration Capacity equals 2 + one per full 10 of Stamina + Resolve, minimum 2, maximum 5. Each point beyond capacity reduces Strain Limit by 1 and creates Medical Dependency or Pattern Instability.

Combined Stamina + Resolve	Capacity
2-9	2
10-19	3
20-29	4
30	5

Implant	G	EP	Integration	Effect
Restorative limb	1	1	0	Restores baseline limb function
Restorative eye	1	1	0	Restores baseline vision

Implant	G	EP	Integration	Effect
Artificial organ	2	2	0	Restores organ function
Neural interface	2	2	1	+1 Technology with linked systems
Sensor eye	2	2	1	+2 one visual detection category
Communications implant	2	2	1	Secure local/planetary communication
Reinforced skeleton	3	3	2	+2 Stability; +1 Protection against crushing
Enhanced arm	3	3	1	+2 lifting and one-arm physical actions
Enhanced legs	3	3	1	+1 Movement step; +2 jumping
Integrated armor	3	3	2	Protection 3 as one source
Integrated weapon	3	3	2	Grade-2 or Grade-3 weapon profile
Medical nanites	4	4	2	Heal 1 Superficial at start of turn once per scene
Memory support	3	3	1	+2 recall and memory-loss resistance
Cybernetic life support	4	4	2	Immune to ordinary suffocation while powered
Technopathic interface	4	4	2	+2 Technopathy/Technology interface
Full-body replacement	5	5	3	Mechanical body; continuity system required
Power-source implant	4-6	4-5	2	Source for a purchased Power
Dimensional stabilizer	5	5	2	+3 resist teleportation/displacement

- Cybernetic systems have their own Structure and Hardness and may be damaged by targeting, EMP, technology suppression, a relevant Critical or Maiming Injury, hacking, or overload.
- At 0 Structure the system is Disabled. Destruction of an integrated system transfers half excess damage, rounded down, as Lethal damage; life support or internal explosions may transfer more.
- Biological Regeneration does not repair mechanical components unless explicitly compatible.
- Cybernetic neural control uses digital Breach plus Resolve + Composure resistance; Willpower may resist once per round.

Powered Armor Chassis

Chassis	G	EP	P	Structure/ Hardness	Reserve	Strain	Slots	Access
Light Exosuit	2	2	4	12/4	6	8	2	3
AEGIS Armor	3	3	6	18/6	12	10	3	4
Assault Warframe	4	4	8	24/8	18	12	4	5
Planetary Bastion	5	5	10	32/10	28	14	5	7
Cosmic Adaptive	6	5	12	40/12	40	16	6	9

System Reserve is separate from character Reserve. Ten minutes of service restores 1; a Short Rest with a charger restores 25%; full service restores all. System Strain uses normal thresholds. On Crash, System Reserve becomes 0, modules shut down, and the chassis suffers damage equal to Strain divided by 4, rounded up.

Powered Armor Modules

Module	Slots	Min Grade	Effect
Strength actuators	1	2	+2 lift, carry, Shove, and Stability
Mobility servos	1	2	+1 Movement step
Flight system	2	3	Personal Flight capability
Environmental seal	1	2	Vacuum and hostile-atmosphere protection
Sensor suite	1	2	Sensor Rating 5 + Grade
Secure communications	1	2	Linked tactical network
Targeting system	1	3	+1 ranged attack die
Force-field module	2	3	Protection 3 or barrier Structure 10
Stealth system	2	3	Concealed 2 against two sensor categories
Suppression projector	2	4	SR 8, SV 2 typed
Medical support	1	3	+2 Medicine; end Bleeding 1 once per scene
AI copilot	1	3	+1 Teamwork die once per scene
Weapon mount	1	2	Mount one compatible weapon
Expanded core	1	2	+4 System Reserve

Module	Slots	Min Grade	Effect
Reserve converter	2	4	Supply 1 Energy to compatible Power once per round
Dimensional anchor	2	4	+3 resist teleportation and phasing
Scale-hardened plating	2	4	Protection remains full against one Scale step higher
Emergency extraction	1	3	Eject or move one Zone as Reaction once per scene
Cyberwarfare defense	1	3	+2 against hacking and EMP
Adaptive environment	2	4	Select three hazard families
Barrier recharge	1	4	Restore 5 barrier Structure for 3 Reserve
Power-calibration interface	1	4	+2 first Overcharge-control roll per scene

Artifacts

Every artifact records Grade, origin, equipment functions, Power or Merit investment, attunement, Reserve source, Techniques, limitations, obligations, vulnerability, growth conditions, and destruction or reforging method.

Category	Definition
Equipment Artifact	Fixed equipment-scale functions.
Bonded Artifact	Merit, Background, or narrative bond; protected against arbitrary permanent loss.
Power Artifact	Source of a purchased Power; destruction disables the Power until replacement or reforging.
Authority Artifact	Setting-level permission; normally Grade 6, GM approval, major story investment.

Archetype	Typical Grade	Functions
Bonded weapon	3-6	Weapon plus Power source or Signature Techniques
Bonded armor	3-6	Protection, adaptation, linked Reserve
Aetheric focus	3-5	+2 Aethercraft and one Mystery specialization
Soul vessel	4-6	Preserve continuity or house a willing spirit
Gate key	4-6	Access a Gate network or dimension
Reality anchor	5-6	Resist or stabilize Reality effects
Ancestral relic	3-6	Memory, Status, lineage permissions
Sentient artifact	4-6	Independent personality and defined actions
Cosmic prison	5-6	Containment and Arbiter functions
Civilization engine	6	Planetary or greater infrastructure
Prophetic archive	5-6	Seer information and historical echoes
Living artifact	4-6	Biological adaptation and regeneration

A sapient artifact has motives and rights, resists mental or digital control, and cannot be treated solely as property. Artifact growth uses normal XP, milestones, components, reforging projects, fulfilled oaths, recovered memories, or resolved corruption. It cannot bypass Tier or Power limits.

10. Personal Combat | Attacks, defenses, maneuvers, cover, and battlefield position

Attack Sequence

26. Declare the action, target, Power, weapon, maneuver, and intended effect.
27. Confirm action cost, range, line of effect, Area, and Scale permissions.
28. Apply ordinary and exceptional modifiers.
29. Build the attack pool and the defender's active or passive defense.
30. Roll and calculate net successes.
31. Calculate Raw Damage: Base Damage + net successes + chosen Critical damage benefit.
32. Apply Protection, Armor Piercing, Resistance, Vulnerability, immunity, and Scale.
33. Apply damage to Health, Structure, barrier, or Cohesion and assign Conditions or Injuries.
34. Resolve Critical benefits, knockback, collateral, resource costs, and Strain.

Active and Passive Defenses

Defense	Pool
Evasion	Dexterity + Athletics + Size modifier
Parry	Dexterity + Melee + weapon or Technique
Block	Stamina + Athletics + Size modifier + shield or Technique
Mental	Resolve + Composure
Social	Composure + Wits

A dedicated shield may use Melee instead of Athletics when higher. To determine Passive Defense, apply ordinary modifiers to the active pool first, divide by 4 rounded up, and add automatic successes.

Unarmed Damage and Natural Weapons

Strength	Unarmed BD
1-3	1
4-6	2
7-9	3
10-12	4
13-15	5

Ordinary unarmed damage is Superficial. Light natural weapons add +1 BD and deal Lethal; heavy natural weapons add +2; massive natural weapons add +3.

Offensive Power Damage

Power Rating	Base Damage
1-2	2
3-4	3
5-6	4
7-8	5
9-10	6
11	7
12	8
13	10
14	12
15	15

Weapon Grade Damage Benchmarks

Grade	Typical BD
0	1-3
1	2-4
2	4-6
3	6-8
4	8-10
5	10-12
6	13-15

Protection and Armor Piercing

When several Protection sources apply, use the highest at full value and half the second-highest, rounded down. No additional ordinary source contributes without an explicit exception. Armor Piercing reduces combined Protection to a minimum of 0; excess AP does not become damage.

- Ordinary Protection applies fully against Superficial, Lethal, and Aggravated damage.
- Against Annihilation, ordinary Protection is halved; dedicated Annihilation protection applies fully.
- Penetrating, Aggravated, or Annihilation sources with a minimum-damage rule deal at least 1 after Protection and resistance unless the target has immunity.
- Resistance halves remaining damage, rounded down. Vulnerability adds 50%, rounded up. Severe Vulnerability doubles. Immunity reduces damage to 0.

Critical Attack Benefits

At 5 or more net successes, choose one normal Critical benefit unless the attack states otherwise.

- +3 Raw Damage
- +2 Armor Piercing
- Apply an appropriate Condition
- Increase knockback
- Disrupt Energy or Reserve
- Damage an attachment, item, or cover
- Avoid collateral while preserving the main effect

Area Attacks and Objects

Roll an Area attack once and compare it to each target's defense separately. One Reaction covers the entire attack. Objects use Structure as Health and Hardness as Protection. A controlled attack suffers -2 ordinary dice to avoid collateral; a Critical may avoid collateral without the penalty.

Combat Maneuvers

Maneuver	Cost and Resolution
Aim - Minor	Gain +1 die to the next ranged attack before end of turn.
Aim - Standard	Gain +2 dice to the next ranged attack before end of next turn and ignore one range or cover penalty. Significant movement ends Aim.
Assist	Standard; use normal Teamwork for a specific declared aid.
Brace	Minor; +2 Stability, ignore Heavy-weapon penalty, +1 resist Knockback until movement.
Charge	Standard + Movement; move toward target, make melee attack, +1 BD; -1 active defense until next turn.
Disarm	Dexterity + Brawl/Melee -2 vs defense; success drops item, Critical seizes or sends it to Near.
Disengage	Minor; Dexterity + Athletics vs highest Passive Parry/Brawl defense. Failure permits one Reaction attack.
Feint	Manipulation + Brawl/Melee/Deception vs Wits + Empathy/Brawl/Melee; success gives target -2 defense against next attack, Critical removes Reaction.
Grapple	Strength + Brawl vs Evasion or physical escape pool; success applies Grappled.
Move Grappled Target	Movement; Strength + Athletics contest; success moves both at half Movement.
Pin	Standard while Grappling; success applies Restrained; Critical also removes Reaction.
Choke	Standard against vulnerable Grappled/Restrained biological target; begins suffocation and applies Dazed.

Maneuver	Cost and Resolution
Escape Grapple	Standard; Strength + Athletics or Dexterity + Brawl vs grappler. Critical also moves one position away.
Guard	Standard; +2 active-defense dice until next turn and may Protect Another once.
Overwatch	Standard and reserve Reaction; declare Area, trigger, and attack.
Protect Another	Reaction; become target, grant +2 defense dice, or interpose shield/barrier.
Reload	Minor for magazine/cell; Standard for heavy; Full/extended for crew-served or complex systems.
Shove	Strength + Brawl/Athletics vs Block or Strength + Athletics; move target one position and possibly Prone.
Sprint	Standard; double normal Movement.
Suppressive Fire	Standard; spend 5 ammunition; selected Zone requires Resolve + Composure difficulty 2 for exposed action or movement; failure applies Suppressed 1.
Trip	Dexterity + Brawl/Melee vs Evasion or Block; success Prone, Critical also Dazed.
Dual Wield	Carry two compatible weapons; choose +1 die to one attack or two attacks with repeated-attack penalties.
Improvised Weapon	Small BD 1, handheld solid BD 2, heavy two-handed BD 3, powered or massive by Scale.
Recover	Standard; attempt one eligible Condition recovery roll.

Cover

Cover	Benefit
Partial	+1 defense die
Standard	+2 defense dice
Heavy	+3 defense dice
Total	No direct targeting without line of effect
Concealing	Concealed 1-3; no physical Protection by itself

Material	Structure	Hardness
Furniture/thin wall	5	1
Wood/civilian door	10	2
Brick/light metal	15	4
Reinforced concrete	25	6
Military alloy	35	8
Strategic super-material	50+	10+

Shooting through cover applies -2 attack dice and adds cover Hardness as Protection. If damage remains, the cover loses Structure equal to pre-target damage and remaining damage reaches the target. An attack that misses only because of cover dice strikes the cover.

Battlefield Positions

Position	Effect
Engaged	Within melee reach; leaving without Disengage may trigger a Reaction attack.
Adjacent	Nearby but not automatically in melee; one Movement closes or opens distance.
Choke Point	Limits how many attackers can engage; passage requires control, Shove, Grapple, movement Power, or defeat.
Elevated	+1 ranged attack die and ignore one ordinary cover point against lower targets.
Flanked	A second attacker from a different direction gains +1 attack die.
Surrounded	Three or more directions; defender suffers -1 active-defense die and cannot apply one facing bonus to all attacks.
Controlled Position	A character actively blocks a doorway, bridge, or route.
Hazardous Position	Entering or beginning a turn triggers the listed hazard.
Vertical Engagement	Walls, ceilings, flight, or shafts; unstable characters suffer -2 Shove resistance and Heavy attacks.

Position	Effect
Mounted/Carried	Use carrier Movement; attacks suffer -1 die unless trained, mounted, or stable.

11. Damage, Healing, Conditions, Injuries, and Hazards |

Consequences and recovery

Damage Types

Type	Rule
Superficial	Cannot reduce Health below 0. Every two further Superficial damage convert one existing Superficial to Lethal.
Lethal	Heals naturally at 1 per 24 hours. Bleeding may continue until treated.
Aggravated	Heals naturally at 1 per week. Ordinary Regeneration does not heal it; explicit healing costs double Energy or functions at half value.
Annihilation	No natural or ordinary healing. Requires explicit reconstruction and surviving continuity.

Incapacitation, Dying, and Death

- At 0 Health the character is Incapacitated.
- At negative Health equal to Stamina the character is Dying.
- At negative Health equal to twice Stamina the character is Dead unless species continuity says otherwise.
- At the end of each round while Dying, roll Stamina + Survival, difficulty 2. Failure causes 1 Lethal; botch 2; Critical stabilizes.
- First Aid uses Intelligence + Medicine, difficulty 2, to stabilize.
- Graven, Brightons, and Mycelyth may persist through their explicit cores, Heartflares, spores, nodes, or continuity anchors. Annihilation of every anchor is true death.

Rest and Natural Recovery

Recovery	Effect
Ten-minute Breather	Remove 1 Strain once between Short Rests.
Short Rest - 1 hour	Heal 6 Superficial, make one temporary-Condition recovery roll, restore 1 Willpower once between Full Rests, restore 25% Reserve.
Full Rest - 8 hours	Heal all Superficial, restore all Willpower and Reserve, and make recovery rolls for eligible Conditions.
Recovery Day	Heal 1 Lethal.
Recovery Week	Heal 1 Aggravated.

Treatment and Healing Value

A Treatment Scene occurs once between Full Rests. Every 3 final Medicine successes convert 1 Lethal to Superficial, maximum 3. Advanced Care accumulates successes; every 5 heals 1 Aggravated when the method permits.

Power Rating	Healing Value
1-2	1
3-4	2
5-6	3
7-8	4
9-10	5
11	6
12	7
13	8
14	10
15	12

Active healing uses a Standard Action and full Healing Value. Passive start-of-turn healing uses half Healing Value, rounded up, once per round.

Reconstruction	Threshold	Typical Time
Minor tissue	5	10 minutes
Major organ	10	1 hour
Limb	15	1 day
Body	30	1 week

Machine field repair restores 1 Structure per 3 successes, maximum 3 per scene. Workshop repair costs 2 successes per ordinary Structure, 3 per Lethal-equivalent, and 5 per Aggravated/Critical Structure. Biological full-body reconstruction normally requires 40 successes and a continuity anchor. Complete energy-form reconstruction requires 30 successes and returns at 25% Health.

Wound States

Health State	Effect
Above half	No wound penalty
Half or less	Wounded: -1 ordinary die to physical Skill and direct Power actions
Quarter or less	Critical: -2 ordinary dice to all actions and Movement -1 step
0	Incapacitated

Willpower may ignore wound penalties until the next turn.

Massive and Catastrophic Damage

- Massive damage is at least 50% maximum Health after mitigation. It causes at least a Major Injury, removes the Reaction, forces Stamina + Survival difficulty 3 or Prone and Dazed/Stunned, and requires a sustained-effect check at difficulty 3.
- Catastrophic damage is at least 75% maximum Health. It causes at least a Maiming Injury, removes the Reaction, applies Prone and Stunned until the next turn, and requires a sustained-effect check at difficulty 5. At 0 Health it causes Dying.

Injury Generation

Determine a provisional Injury grade, then resist. Physical Injuries use Stamina + Survival. Mental, spiritual, energy, and existential Injuries normally use Resolve + Composure or a suitable specialized pool.

Grade	Difficulty
Minor	2
Major	3
Maiming	4
Existential	5

- Success reduces the Injury by one grade. Critical avoids it. Failure applies it. Botch raises it one grade. Maiming becomes Existential only when the source is eligible.
- A hit dealing at least 25% maximum Health indicates Minor, 50% Major, and 75% Maiming.
- Reaching 0 through Lethal or Aggravated damage causes at least Major; becoming Dying causes at least Maiming.
- Annihilation dealing at least 10% maximum Health causes at least Major; reaching 0 or directly striking a continuity anchor prompts an Existential check.
- A called shot suffers -3 ordinary dice. If it deals at least 1 damage, it causes at least a Minor Injury to the chosen location.

Injury Examples by Location

Location	Minor	Major	Maiming	Existential
Head	Dazed; -1 mental die	Stunned; -2 mental dice	Unconscious or severe cognitive damage	Identity or brain pattern destroyed
Eye	Blinded 1	One eye lost; depth penalties	Primary vision destroyed	Supernatural sight anchor destroyed
Ear	Deafened 1	One ear lost; balance -1	Ordinary hearing lost	Psychic or lineage hearing destroyed
Jaw	Speech/bite -1	Speech unclear; bite disabled	Jaw destroyed	Vocal Power anchor destroyed
Neck	Movement/speech -1	Bleeding 2; breathing impaired	Paralysis or decapitation risk	Continuity severed
Torso	Wound penalty worsens	Internal damage; healing reduced	Organ collapse	Body continuity fails
Heart	Exhausted 1	Dying threshold reduced	Heart destroyed; immediate Dying	Life-pattern anchor destroyed
Lung	Breath capacity halved	Suffocation under exertion	Ordinary respiration impossible	Species respiration pattern destroyed
Arm	-1 using arm	Arm unusable	Arm destroyed	Regrowth pattern destroyed

Location	Minor	Major	Maiming	Existential
Hand	Fine manipulation -2	Hand unusable	Hand lost	Integrated Power focus destroyed
Leg	Movement -1	Movement halved	Leg lost	Locomotion pattern destroyed
Wing	Flight -1 step	Flight control -3	Wing destroyed	Flight-organ pattern destroyed
Cybernetic	Jammed	Disabled	Destroyed; transfer damage	Neural integration collapse
Graven core	Memory errors	Memory/personality fragmentation	Core cracked	Core annihilated
Heartflare	Power instability	Reconstruction impaired	Outer form collapses	Heartflare annihilated
Mycelyth node	Network penalty	Local colony severed	Major network collapse	All continuity nodes destroyed
Soul	Pressured/Frightened	Corruption or fragmentation	Displaced or bound	Soul annihilated
Aether channel	+1 Energy cost	-2 effective Aether rating	Mystery inaccessible	Aether identity severed
Psychic identity	Suspicious/Pressured	Memory/personality fracture	Overwrite risk	Foundational self erased
Dimensional tether	Teleport scatter	Cannot return to anchor	Trapped between dimensions	Spatial continuity erased

Conditions

Condition	Core Effect
Blinded	Severity 1: -2 sight dice; 2: -4 and ranged attacks need another sense; 3: no sight and Passive Defense against unseen attacks.
Deafened	Severity 1: -2 auditory Awareness; 2: ordinary speech unavailable; 3: no ordinary hearing.
Bleeding	At end of round suffer Lethal equal to Severity until Medicine or healing ends it.
Burning	At end of turn suffer damage equal to Severity; source defines damage type. Standard action and appropriate roll extinguishes.
Frozen	Severity 1 Movement -1; 2 Movement halved and -2 Dexterity dice; 3 Immobilized and 1 Lethal/round.
Poisoned	Profile-specific; generally -1 die per Severity to physical recovery/endurance.
Diseased	Profile-specific; healing received reduced by Severity unless treatment addresses disease.
Prone	Melee attackers +1 die; distant ranged attackers -1 die; standing costs Movement.
Grappled	Cannot freely leave; -2 attacks not against grappler; Standard action to escape.
Restrained	Movement 0; -3 Dexterity dice; no active Evasion; Standard action to escape or break restraint.
Immobilized	Movement 0; other actions remain unless source says otherwise.
Stunned	Lose Standard and Reaction until end of next turn; may take one Minor and communicate briefly.
Dazed	-2 action dice; no more than one Reaction; normally ends at end of next turn.
Frightened	Severity 1 to 3 imposes -1 to -3 while confronting source and may force Fall Back.
Dominated	Uses Mental Intrusion; Severity summarizes impulse, command, or direct control. Willpower permits resistance or refusal of one action.
Exhausted	Severity 1: -1 physical/Power-control; 2: -2 and Movement -1; 3: -3, no Sprint or Overcharge.
Power Crashed	Reserve 0, sustained effects end, Exhausted, and Power unavailable until Reserve restored.
Suppressed	Severity summarizes typed Power reduction; actual suppression requires valid SR/SV and resistance.
Invisible	Cannot be seen normally; other senses and environmental disturbance remain. Attacking usually reveals location.
Concealed	Severity 1 to 3 imposes -1 to -3 detection and attack dice. Does not automatically re-hide a known target.
Incapacitated	No actions or active defense; follow Dying rules when applicable.
Receptive	+2 ordinary dice to the next relevant social action; ends after use or scene.
Pressured	Severity 1 to 3 imposes -1 to -3 resisting the same source/objective.
Inspired	+1 die per Severity toward declared goal; reduce after a major benefiting action.
Suspicious	+1 die per Severity to detect related Deception; social threshold increases by Severity.
Jammed	Item cannot use primary active function until cleared.
Disabled	Equipment, cybernetic, or module provides no active function until repaired or reset.

Environmental Hazard Procedure

At each hazard interval, roll the listed resistance pool against difficulty. Success halves damage and avoids or reduces the Condition by 1. Critical avoids ordinary damage and Conditions for the interval. Failure applies full effect. Botch increases damage by 50%, rounded up, and raises one Condition by 1.

Hazard	Diff	Damage	Interval	Resistance	Additional Effect
Open flame	2	BD 2 Lethal	Round	Stamina + Survival	Burning 1
Structural fire	3	BD 4 Lethal	Round	Stamina + Survival	Burning 1; smoke

Hazard	Diff	Damage	Interval	Resistance	Additional Effect
Dense smoke	2	None initially	Round	Stamina + Survival	Blinded 1, then Exhausted 1
Drowning	3	BD 2 Lethal after breath	Round	Stamina + Athletics	Dazed; eventual Dying
Suffocation	3	BD 2 Lethal after breath	Round	Stamina + Survival	Exhausted 1
Vacuum	5	BD 3 Lethal	Round	Stamina + Survival	Dazed and suffocation
Decompression	5	BD 5 Lethal	Immediate	Stamina + Athletics	Forced movement and Prone
Severe heat	3	BD 2 Superficial	10 minutes	Stamina + Survival	Exhausted 1
Extreme heat	5	BD 4 Lethal	Minute	Stamina + Survival	Burning 1
Severe cold	3	BD 2 Superficial	10 minutes	Stamina + Survival	Frozen 1
Extreme cold	5	BD 4 Lethal	Minute	Stamina + Survival	Frozen 2
Radiation	3-8	BD 2-8 Aggravated	Hour/round	Stamina + Survival	Diseased or Exhausted
Corrosive atmosphere	4	BD 3 Lethal	Minute	Stamina + Survival	Equipment loses Structure
Industrial acid	4	BD 5 Lethal	Round	Stamina + Survival	Burning 1
Exotic acid	7	BD 8 Aggravated	Round	Stamina + Survival	Protection -1
Electrical exposure	3	BD 4 Lethal	Immediate	Stamina + Athletics	Dazed
Strategic surge	6	BD 8 Lethal	Immediate	Stamina + Athletics	Stunned on failure
High gravity	3-7	BD 1-5	Round	Strength + Athletics	Immobilized or Prone
Low gravity	2	Usually none	Scene	Dexterity + Athletics	Uncontrolled movement
Crushing pressure	4-8	BD 4-10 Lethal	Minute/round	Stamina + Survival	Restrained or Injury
Reentry	8	BD 12 Aggravated	Round	Stamina + Survival	Burning 3
Stellar exposure	10	BD 15 Aggravated	Round	Stamina + Survival	Burning 3 and radiation
Antimatter	10+	BD 15+ Annihilation	Immediate	Appropriate defense	Area destruction
Dimensional instability	5-9	BD 4-10 Aggravated	Round	Resolve + Composure	Displacement and Dazed
Aether storm	4-9	BD 3-10 Aggravated/Energy	Round	Resolve + Aethercraft	Strain and disruption
Psychic environment	3-8	Mental Injury or WP loss	Scene/round	Resolve + Composure	Frightened or Dominated
Reality collapse	8-10+	BD 10-15 Annihilation	Round	Resolve + Composure/Authority	Identity and Scale disruption

Falling and Collision

Fall	Base Damage
Under 10 feet	1 Superficial
10-30 feet	3 Lethal
30-100 feet	6 Lethal
100-300 feet	9 Lethal
300+ feet	12 Lethal
Orbital	Reentry and Scale rules

Dexterity + Athletics, difficulty 2-5, reduces falling Base Damage by final successes to a maximum of half. Collision BD is 2, 4, 6, 8, and 10+ for movement rates of 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5+ Zones per round, with Size and Scale added normally.

Diseases, Toxins, and Drugs

Disease	Rating	Core Effect
Common systemic infection	2	Diseased 1, Exhausted 1; daily interval
Severe respiratory plague	4	Diseased 2 and reduced Breath Capacity
Alien nerve parasite	5	-2 Dexterity and Dazed episodes
Psychic contagion	5	Frightened or false memories
Aetheric corruption	6	+1 Strain from Aether use and visible resonance
Mycelyth spore blight	4	Poisoned 1 and network interference
Graven memory corrosion	6	Memory loss and Core Injury
Brighton resonance instability	6	Energy leakage and Reserve loss
Alder Wasting manifestation	8	Life-pattern degradation; managed rather than ordinarily cured
Engineered extinction agent	8	Aggravated damage and Diseased 3
Dimensional parasite	7	Teleport scatter and Health loss

Disease	Rating	Core Effect
Reality infection	9	Identity and physical-law destabilization

Toxin	Rating	Effect
Irritant gas	2	Blinded 1 and coughing
Sedative	3	Exhausted 2; unconscious at Severity 3
Paralytic	5	Immobilized, then Restrained-equivalent
Neurotoxin	6	Dazed, Dexterity -3, Lethal damage
Hemotoxin	5	Bleeding 1-2
Corrosive venom	5	BD 3 Lethal and Burning 1
Alien metabolic toxin	6	Species-specific Exhaustion and damage
Aether poison	6	+2 Energy costs and Strain
Anti-regeneration toxin	7	Regeneration disabled for scene
Soul venom	8	Aggravated damage and Soul Injury

Drug	Rating	Benefit	Risk
Analgesic	1	Ignore 1 wound-penalty die	May conceal worsening Injury
Sedative	2	+2 against panic/agitation	Exhausted 1
Field stimulant	2	Temporarily remove Exhausted 1	Returns after scene
Combat stimulant	4	+1 physical die and +1 Movement step	1 Strain and Exhausted 1 afterward
Focus enhancer	3	+2 one mental Skill category	-1 social awareness
Regenerative compound	5	Heal 3 Superficial or 1 Lethal once/day	Species compatibility
Power suppressant	5	Apply Suppressed 1 to one source	Resistance
Anti-psycho agent	4	+2 Mental Defense	Empathy and telepathy -2
Aether stabilizer	4	Reduce Aetheric Strain by 1 once/scene	Cannot reduce below 0
Revival agent	5	Immediate Dying test at +3 dice	Exhausted 2
Radiation chelator	4	+3 radiation recovery	Dehydration
Universal antitoxin	4	Reduce ordinary Poisoned by 1	Ineffective against exotic toxins

12. Social and Psychic Conflict | Influence without unrestricted mind control

Social Conflict Principles

Ordinary social actions influence decisions; they do not override agency. Before rolling, define Objective, Stakes, Approach, Attitude, and Leverage.

HARD BOUNDARY

Ordinary social conflict cannot force suicide, irreversible betrayal of core identity, nonconsensual sexual or romantic conduct, permanent personality change, impossible conduct, impossible knowledge, or authority the target does not possess.

Social Defense

Active Social Defense is Composure + Wits and costs a Reaction in structured time. Passive Social Defense is the modified active pool divided by 4, rounded up, plus automatic successes.

Situation	Specialized Defense
Intimidation or interrogation	Mental Defense
Detecting lies	Wits + Empathy or Intelligence + Investigation
Formal protocol	Composure + Etiquette
Group command or persuasion	Resolve + Leadership

Quick Social Results

A normal success earns a limited concession appropriate to the target's interests. A Critical may make the target Receptive, improve Attitude by 1 for the scene, remove immediate resentment, conceal a deeper motive, gain an extra minor concession, or accelerate action. It does not create permanent obligation or loyalty.

Extended Social Influence

Objective	Threshold
Minor	3
Significant	6
Major	10
Extreme	15
Campaign	25

Add net successes as Influence Progress. A botch removes 3 Progress and creates a complication.

Attitude	Threshold Modifier
Fanatical Opposition	+10
Hostile	+5
Wary	+2
Neutral	0
Open	-1
Friendly	-3
Devoted	-5

Values, risk, identity, and incompatible interests may add +3 to +10 or make the objective impossible. Final threshold cannot fall below 1.

Leverage and Obligations

Leverage ranges from 0 to 3. Each point grants +1 die, or after a successful action may be spent to reduce remaining threshold by 2. Obligations are rated 1 minor, 2 serious, and 3 major.

Social States

State	Effect
Receptive	+2 ordinary dice to the next relevant social action.
Pressured 1-3	-1 per Severity resisting the same source or objective.
Inspired 1-3	+1 die per Severity toward the declared goal; reduce after a major benefiting action.
Suspicious 1-3	+1 per Severity to detect related Deception and threshold +Severity.

Mental Intrusion

A psychic attacker rolls governing Attribute + effective Power Rating against active Mental Defense, Resolve + Composure, or Passive Mental Defense.

Level	Name	Minimum Rating	Meaning
0	Contact	1	Communication, presence, or voluntary link
1	Intrusion	3	Surface access, illusion, emotional touch
2	Influence	5	Compulsion, significant emotional or memory effect
3	Control	7 or 9	Direct command or sustained control
4	Possession	9 or 12	Occupy or operate through the target
5	Rewrite	12 or 15	Foundational memory, identity, or mental architecture

Level 2 normally requires 3 net successes on one roll or 5 accumulated Breach. Levels 3 and 4 use a Mental Clash. At +3 clash margin the attacker gains partial effect; at +5 full effect. At -5 the defender breaks the effect and prevents immediate reapplication during the scene unless circumstances materially change.

Willpower Against Psychic Effects

- Spend Willpower for immediate resistance.
- Ignore one compelled action.
- Test an illusion or false perception.
- Resist memory, identity, or possession effects.
- Permanent erasure or rewrite of a player character requires player consent; otherwise consequences are temporary or recoverable.

Mental Applications

Application	Permission
Telepathy	Communication and thought access according to Intrusion Level.
Emotion	Create or alter emotional state within consent and control limits.
Illusion	False sensory or cognitive experience; contradiction permits resistance.
Fear	Apply Frightened or Morale pressure.
Compulsion	Clear command at Influence Level or higher; prohibited commands remain invalid.
Domination	Direct control requiring appropriate rating and clash.
Memory	Read, seal, revise, or restore according to Branch and level.
Possession	Operate through a target with Level 4 permission.
Identity Rewrite	Extended Level 5 work, strong safeguards, and player consent for permanence.

13. Stealth, Chases, Digital Conflict, and Morale | Operational scene engines

Stealth Awareness States

State	Meaning
Unaware	No recognized threat
Alert	General concern
Suspicious	Specific irregularity
Searching	Active attempt to locate
Engaged	Target located and conflict underway

Hidden is source-specific. A character may be hidden visually but detected thermally, psychically, Aetherically, digitally, or through sound. Concealed 1-3 applies -1 to -3 relevant detection and attack dice but does not automatically re-hide a known target.

Suspicion and Infiltration Clocks

Local Suspicion runs 0-6: calm, uncertain, alert, suspicious, searching, alarm imminent, and alarm. Failed Stealth normally adds 1; botch adds 2 and a clue; a Critical may reduce 1 or create a false trail.

Infiltration Progress	State
0	Outside/planning
1	Perimeter
2	Access
3	Internal
4	Restricted
5	Objective accessible
6	Objective secured

Alarm	State
0	Routine
1	Local attention
2	Verification
3	Guards redirected
4	Lockdown
5	Armed hunt
6	Full response

A successful exchange adds 1 Progress; Critical adds 2 or 1 plus a secondary benefit; failure adds 1 Alarm; botch adds 2 Alarm and a complication.

Group Stealth and Security Layers

- One character leads. Helpers use Teamwork. A member whose pool is five below the leader may impose -1 exceptional penalty; several weak members -2; an extremely unsuitable group -3 unless mitigated.
- Security layers are Perimeter, Access, Surveillance, Internal Control, Restricted Core, and Extraction.
- Security categories are Physical, Electronic, Personnel, Aetheric, Psychic, and Environmental.
- Return to hiding requires breaking line or effect, sufficient concealment, and a Standard Dexterity + Stealth action against active search.

Sensors

Sensors detect defined categories. Passive sensor value is rating divided by 3, rounded up. Active use rolls rating or operator Intelligence + Technology. Sensor Scale follows normal Scale rules. A sensor three Scales above concealment cannot be fully evaded without Scale-Breaker, same-Scale masking, blind spots, shielding, network compromise, or false signals.

Chase Distance

Distance	State
0	Contact or captured
1	Engaged
2	Near
3	Far
4	Extreme
5	Strategic or barely tracked
6	Escaped

Each round both sides choose actions, resolve obstacles and attacks, roll opposed pools, and shift Distance. The quarry wins ties except at Contact, a prepared intercept, a trap, or an explicit Technique. Net 1-4 shifts one band; Critical or 5+ net shifts two, maximum two normally.

Chase Action	Typical Pool
Sprint	Dexterity + Athletics, Flight, or Power
Navigate	Wits + Survival/Streetwise, Dexterity + Athletics, Intelligence + Piloting, or Power
Create/Exploit Obstacle	Relevant physical, technical, social, or Power pool
Hide	Normally Distance 3+; Stealth or masking
Attack	-2 ordinary dice while chasing; heavy attacks -3 or impossible
Intercept	Strategy, route knowledge, teleportation, or superior Mobility
Assist	Normal Teamwork

- Teleportation may shift 1 band at Near, 2 at Far/Extreme, or set Distance 5-6 at Strategic if the pursuer cannot follow. Predictable destinations can be intercepted.
- One Movement Scale step grants +3 exceptional dice; two steps +6 and +1 automatic success; three steps makes direct pursuit impossible without shortcuts, teleportation, tracking, interception, or Scale-Breaker.
- Group chases use one lead per side. If the group remains together, the slowest plausible member limits movement.

Digital System Profile

Digital systems record Security Rating 1-15, Access 0-5, Integrity, Digital Hardness, Detection 0-6, Trace 0-5, Lockout, Network Scope, AI status, functions, and air-gap status.

Access	Permission
0	None
1	Guest/public
2	User
3	Privileged/operator
4	Administrator
5	Root or sovereign

Roll Intelligence + Technology or Intelligence + Technopathy against Security Rating or active defender. Breach runs 0-10; at Breach 2, 4, 6, 8, and 10 the intruder gains Access 1-5. A successful action adds net successes as Breach, maximum 3 per ordinary action. Failure adds 1 Detection; botch adds 2 Detection and a countermeasure.

Digital Detection and Trace

Detection	State
0	Unseen
1	Anomaly
2	Flagged; +1 monitoring
3	Confirmed intrusion
4	Active counterintrusion; +2 trace/counter

Detection	State
5	Lockout and containment
6	Full response

Trace	Result
1-2	Route or relay
3-4	Region, device, or access point
5	Exact user, device, or origin

Digital Actions and Malware

Minimum Access	Typical Permission
1	Read public/basic data
2	Personal or operational data; routine controls
3	Restricted/classified data; persistent access; malware
4	Security, weapons, strategic controls
5	Core secrets and sovereign control

Malware	Minimum Access	Effect
Spyware	2	Copies activity and selected data
Credential thief	2	Produces one reusable credential
Sensor spoof	3	Creates false sensor data
False-record package	3	Alters one record category
Command hijack	4	Seizes one subsystem
Logic bomb	3	Triggers sabotage on a condition
Lockout package	3	Denies selected users
Corruption worm	3	Deals 2 Corruption per interval
Persistent backdoor	3	Preserves Access 2 after logout
AI-targeting virus	4	-2 AI defense and actions
Cybernetic intrusion	3	+2 against one implant family
Aether-tech corruption	4	Adds Instability to hybrid systems
Network contagion	4	Spreads to linked nodes

Countermeasure	Effect
Automated trace	Adds Trace after failed intrusion
Credential revocation	Removes one access route
Node isolation	Disconnects compromised subsystem
Honeypot	Creates false Access and increases Trace
Counterhack	Attacks Breach or intruder Integrity
Active AI defender	Uses active Technology or Technopathy
Digital damage pulse	Deals Corruption to intruding device
False database	Feeds controlled misinformation
Aetheric quarantine	Requires Aethercraft to bypass
Memory purge	Deletes selected sensitive data
Hard reset	Ends access but may interrupt system
Physical severance	Turns conflict into physical objective

Sapient AI and Cybernetics

Sapient AI receives character protections. Use Intelligence + Technology/Technopathy and Resolve + Composure or Mental Defense for autonomy. Ordinary hacking cannot permanently enslave a sapient intelligence. Direct neural control of cybernetics also permits Resolve

+ Composure and Willpower resistance. Air-gapped systems require physical access, an insider, supply-chain compromise, or explicit extraordinary crossing permission.

Digital Damage

Corruption uses Base Damage + net successes against Digital Hardness. Integrity functions like Structure. At half Integrity the system is Impaired; at 0 it crashes; destruction requires rebuild or backup restoration.

Morale

Individuals roll Resolve + Composure. Groups roll commander Resolve or Charisma + Leadership, or a representative group Resolve + Composure. Base difficulty is 2.

- Test after leader loss, Massive or Catastrophic damage, half the force lost, a Threat Class at least two higher, encirclement, objective loss, Annihilation, loss of escape, failed reinforcement, credible surrender, or allied abandonment.
- Additional major triggers in the same round add +1 difficulty each, maximum +3.
- Prepared retreat, trusted leader, superior position, or Inspired may reduce difficulty by 1 each.

Result	Outcome
Critical	Hold; remove one morale Condition, gain Inspired 1, restore formation, or ignore next ordinary trigger
Success	Hold
Failure by 1-2	Pressured 1
Failure by 3-4	Frightened 1 and Fall Back
Failure by 5+	Surrender or Rout
Botch	Collapse or panic

A trapped or ideological force may choose Desperate Last Stand instead of surrender or rout: Inspired 2, +2 ordinary dice toward one defensive objective, no voluntary retreat, and Massive damage raises provisional Injury one grade. Rally is a Standard Charisma/Resolve/Composure + Leadership action, difficulty 2; every 2 final successes reduce Pressured or Frightened by 1, end Fall Back, restore formation, or reconsider surrender.

14. Encounter Difficulty and Attrition | Evaluating completed opponents, hazards, and parties

Encounter difficulty is calculated from completed profiles. It does not construct NPCs. The system evaluates five pressure axes: Health Attrition, Action/Control Attrition, Resource Attrition, Spike Risk, and Scale/Mobility Pressure. The final class is normally the second-highest axis, subject to explicit hard overrides.

Class	Meaning	Recovery Load
Trivial	Negligible danger or resource use	0
Minor	Modest resistance; serious consequences unlikely	1
Standard	Meaningful tactical challenge and measurable attrition	2
Severe	Significant danger; poor decisions may incapacitate	3
Boss	Centerpiece confrontation requiring major resources	4
Crisis	Defeat plausible; several characters may be lost	6
Catastrophic	Destruction or mission collapse likely without a special solution	8+

Encounter Record

- Party size, effective party size, current Health, effective Health, current Reserve, remaining Strain capacity, Willpower, actions, sustained damage, healing, defenses, Protection, and Scales.
- Hostile effective actions, expected damage, control, Area, suppression, Health, barriers, healing, Scales, and expected duration.
- Five pressure-axis classes, final class, Recovery Load, tags, and separate Stakes grade.

Expected Success Estimate

For encounter planning only, Expected Success Value equals rolled dice divided by 3 plus automatic successes. This estimate does not replace actual dice.

Attack Margin	Expected Hit Rate
-2.5 or lower	10%
-2.49 to -1.5	25%
-1.49 to -0.5	40%
-0.49 to +0.49	50%
+0.5 to +1.49	65%
+1.5 to +2.49	80%
+2.5 or higher	95%

Positive Margin	Expected Net Successes on Hit
0 or lower	1
+0.5 to +1.49	2
+1.5 to +2.49	3
+2.5 to +3.49	4
+3.5 or higher	5

Expected Damage

Expected hit damage equals Base Damage + expected net successes - effective Protection after AP, then applies Scale, resistance, vulnerability, immunity, and minimum damage. Expected damage per target equals hit damage multiplied by expected hit rate.

Area	Expected Targets
Single	1
Cluster	Up to 2
Small Area	Up to 3

Area	Expected Targets
One Zone	Half the party, rounded up
One Zone while confined	All party members
Several Zones/battlefield	All exposed characters

Expected Duration and Persistence

Expected rounds equal hostile effective Health divided by party sustainable post-mitigation damage, rounded up. Add reliable barriers and healing to effective Health. If passive healing or Protection equals or exceeds sustainable damage, mark Regeneration/Protection Lock and treat the encounter as at least Crisis or as a counter-required objective.

Hostile Structure	Persistence
Many ordinary enemies	0.70
Elite group or pair	0.85
Solo enemy	1.00
Constant hazard	1.00

Expected party Health loss equals hostile expected damage per round x expected rounds x persistence.

Pressure Bands

Ratio	Health/Resource Class
Below 5%	Trivial
5-14%	Minor
15-29%	Standard
30-49%	Severe
50-69%	Boss
70-99%	Crisis
100%+	Catastrophic

Lost-Action Ratio	Action/Control Class
Below 5%	Trivial
5-9%	Minor
10-19%	Standard
20-29%	Severe
30-39%	Boss
40-59%	Crisis
60%+	Catastrophic

Single-Hit Damage / Weakest Health	Spike Class
Below 15%	Trivial
15-24%	Minor
25-39%	Standard
40-59%	Severe
60-79%	Boss
80-99%	Crisis
100%+	Catastrophic

Control Equivalents

Effect	Lost Standard Equivalent
Soft Severity-1 penalty or minor forced movement	0.25
Dazed, Prone, Grappled, or comparable interference	0.5
Stunned, Restrained, Immobilized, major Suppression, or turn denial	1.0
Domination, Possession, or Incapacitation-level control	1.5

Multiply by expected application chance, targets, and duration. Solo player characters multiply control burden by 1.5; two-character parties by 1.25.

Suppression Burden

Effect	Lost-Action Equivalent per Target/Round
-1 to -2 effective rating or +1 Energy	0.25
-3 to -5 or Branch lock	0.5
Core Power or Reserve lock	0.75
Total Nullification	1.0

If suppression removes more than half the party's sustainable output, recalculate duration, damage, and Scale pressure.

Action Economy

Effect	Effective Actions
Standard/Full offensive or control action	1.0
Damaging or controlling Reaction	0.5
Minor offensive/control effect	0.5
Persistent aura or hazard pulse	0.5
Pure movement/position effect	0.25
Extra Standard Action	1.0

Action Ratio	Assessment
0.50 or less	Underactive
0.51-0.80	Stable
0.81-1.10	High
1.11-1.50	Oppressive
Above 1.50	Extreme

A ratio above 1.25 raises Action/Control pressure by one class unless the additional actions are weak, objective-only, or positional.

Scale and Mobility Pressure

Situation	Class
Party advantage or no meaningful lock	Trivial
Narrow hostile movement or position edge	Minor
One meaningful Scale step or strong range control	Standard
Two steps with accessible counters	Severe
Two steps plus dominant movement or Area	Boss
Three steps with one narrow exploit/objective route	Crisis
Three or more steps with no valid counter	Catastrophic

Solo Tempo

Effective PCs	Tempo Points/Round
1-2	1
3-4	2
5-6	3
7-8	4

Boss-or-higher solos may spend 1 Tempo to refresh a Reaction, move one Zone, end Prone or Dazed, reduce a Severity-1 Condition, activate a minor environment effect, use a Minor-equivalent Technique, or shift stance. Spend 2 to reduce hard control by one grade, trigger a phase transition, refresh a reduced barrier, or reposition after a Critical. No more than one Tempo use per round directly deals damage unless the profile already grants more. At 75%, 50%, and 25% Health, the solo may gain 1 immediate Tempo and clear one soft Condition.

Mixed-Tier Parties

Participation	Weight
Can affect and survive normally	1.0
One meaningful Tier/Scale disadvantage	0.75
Two-step disadvantage but viable support role	0.50
Only indirect assistance	0.25
Cannot meaningfully participate	0

Effective party size is the sum of weights. Evaluate individual Spike Risk separately. A participating character facing Catastrophic Spike makes the encounter at least Crisis unless reliable protection or a protected role exists.

Hard Overrides

- Crisis Spike makes the encounter at least Boss.
- Catastrophic Spike makes the encounter at least Crisis and usually Catastrophic when accurate, repeatable, Area-based, or likely to strike the weakest character.
- An uncountered three-step Scale advantage is Catastrophic.
- A Protection or healing lock is at least Crisis and should be marked Stalemate or Counter Required.
- Total suppression of more than half the party raises the encounter at least one class; helplessness is Catastrophic.
- No viable victory, escape, delay, negotiation, weak point, rescue, or objective route is Catastrophic.

Rest Pacing

A Short Rest is normally expected after 4 accumulated Recovery Load. A Full Rest is normally expected after 8.

- Short Rest pacing: four Minor, two Standard, one Severe plus one Minor, or one Boss.
- Full Rest pacing: eight Minor, four Standard, two Severe plus one Standard, two Boss, or one Crisis with little additional pressure.
- Recalculate every chained encounter using current Health, Reserve, Strain, Willpower, Injuries, Conditions, consumables, and equipment damage.

Encounter Tags

- Health-Heavy
- Reserve-Heavy
- Strain-Heavy
- Control-Heavy
- Area-Heavy
- Spike-Heavy
- Suppression-Heavy
- Mobile
- Scale-Locked
- Regeneration-Locked
- Objective-Driven
- Hazard-Driven
- Attritional
- Burst Encounter

15. Mission Structure | Objectives, pressure, preparation, extraction, and consequences

A Mission is an objective-driven sequence of linked Scene Nodes. It is not a fixed railroad. Players may change routes, priorities, methods, support, and objectives. Operation Load measures mechanical attrition; Stakes measure narrative consequence.

Mission Profile

- Mission name, sponsor, authority, operational level, Operation Load, and Stakes.
- Primary, secondary, and optional objectives.
- Rules of Engagement, constraints, known opposition, and Intelligence Level.
- Prepared Advantages, Support Assets, pressure tracks, Scene Nodes, rest opportunities, extraction, failure states, and aftermath.

Operation Load

Load	Operational Level
0-3	Patrol or Light Operation
4-7	Standard Operation
8-11	Major Operation
12-15	Crisis Operation
16+	Campaign Operation

Operation Load is the sum of expected Encounter Recovery Load. A mission above 4 should normally include a Short Rest, medical asset, resupply, Lair, or deliberate choice to continue depleted. A mission above 8 should normally be divided into phases unless endurance is the intended challenge.

Stakes Grades

Grade	Examples
Routine	Equipment, inconvenience, minor assignment
Personal	Individual life, identity, relationship, or freedom
Mission	Primary objective, team, or important civilians
Strategic	City, major facility, faction position
Planetary	World or civilization
Interstellar	Multiple systems or civilizations
Existential	Species, reality, causality, universe, or continuity

Objectives and Outcomes

A Primary Objective defines mission success. Secondary Objectives improve the result. Optional Objectives provide advantages, discoveries, equipment, Reputation, or future access. Complex objectives normally use Progress 0-6: success +1, Critical +2, botch may remove 1. Define visible milestones at Progress 2, 4, and 6.

Outcome	Definition
Decisive Success	Primary achieved, most secondary goals achieved, limited consequences, strategic position improves.
Success	Primary achieved and team retains control or extracts within expected cost.
Costly Success	Primary achieved but a major cost occurs: casualties, exposure, asset loss, capture, severe Reputation or Background damage.
Partial Success	Primary not fully achieved, but a meaningful alternative preserves part of the Stakes.
Failure	Primary fails, Stakes worsen, but the campaign continues from a changed situation.
Catastrophic Failure	Primary fails and worst established consequence occurs; no normal immediate recovery remains.

Mission Phases

35. Trigger and authorization.
36. Briefing and acceptance.
37. Intelligence and preparation.
38. Deployment and approach.
39. Entry or initial obstacle.
40. Operational loop.
41. Escalation or reversal.
42. Climax.
43. Extraction.
44. Debrief and consequences.
45. Recovery, downtime, and advancement.

Authorization

State	Meaning
Authorized	Clear legal or organizational approval and support.
Limited	Approval exists within defined boundaries.
Covert	Sponsor approves but will not acknowledge the operation publicly.
Unofficial	No formal sanction; characters rely on personal access and secrecy.
Hostile/Illegal	Authorities consider the mission criminal, insurgent, or unauthorized.

Intelligence Level

Level	State	Required Information
0	Unknown	Broad purpose, approximate target or location, immediate Stakes. Up to two unrevealed major complications.
1	Partial	Primary Objective, broad opposition, basic location, one hazard or security layer.
2	Standard	Major opposition, security layers, likely reinforcement, entry/extraction routes, hazards, timetable.
3	Comprehensive	Most preexisting relevant information plus one enemy weakness, hidden route, command vulnerability, internal conflict, or phase warning.

A distinct successful intelligence action raises the level by 1; Critical may raise 2, maximum 3. Repeating the same method against the same source does not repeatedly increase Intelligence.

Prepared Advantages

A team normally holds no more than three Prepared Advantages, including those generated by Lairs, Safe Havens, planning, research, and reconnaissance.

Advantage	Use
Equipment Cache	Produce one reasonable item or consumable supported by access.
Threat Dossier	+2 dice to first relevant Awareness, Investigation, Strategy, Science, Xenology, Occult, or Aethercraft action.
Countermeasure	+2 resistance dice once against one known damage type, hazard, Condition, suppression source, or Power interaction.
Planned Route	Reduce local Alarm by 1, bypass routine travel obstacle, shift Chase Distance by 1, or use an alternate route.
Extraction Plan	Begin extraction at Chase Distance 4 or reach a Secure point when uncontested.
Medical Preparation	+2 first Medicine roll, end Bleeding 1 once, or stabilize one Dying character with appropriate gear.
Power Calibration	Reduce first Technique Energy by 1, or +2 first Power/Overcharge-control roll.
Identity Cover	Ignore first Exposure or Lair Pressure increase from routine records, cameras, forensics, or travel patterns.
Legal Authority	Bypass one jurisdiction obstacle, gain temporary Clearance, prevent one ordinary legal consequence, or compel routine cooperation.
Decoy	Redirect patrol or pursuit, delay reinforcements, or reduce Alert by 1.

Support Assets

Support Assets are larger external resources, separate from Prepared Advantages. They come from Backgrounds, organizations, equipment, Safe Havens, or story access. Record function, availability, arrival time, range, uses, conditions, vulnerability, and political or Background cost.

- Medical evacuation
- Air or orbital support
- Command and intelligence team
- Tactical Formation
- Transport or Gate access
- Legal team
- Cyberwarfare cell
- Aetheric ritual circle
- Emergency sanctuary
- Supply depot or Safehouse

Approach

Approach	Initial Benefit
Covert	+1 first Stealth, Larceny, Deception, or concealment action; first overt attack normally raises Alert 1.
Rapid	+2 first deployment, chase, rescue, or Initiative action; no more preparation after deployment.
Forceful	+1 first attack or Intimidation; Alert begins at 1 unless already overt.
Diplomatic	+1 first Persuasion, Etiquette, or Leadership; overt weapons may be restricted.
Deceptive	+1 first Deception, impersonation, or false-access action; failure raises Exposure or Alert.
Distributed	Team splits among nodes; no shared Teamwork, shared pressure applies, extraction is more difficult if communication fails.

Operational Loop

46. Choose the next objective or Scene Node.
47. Declare approach.
48. Establish entry conditions.
49. Resolve the scene.
50. Apply Health, resource, equipment, and Background consequences.
51. Update Objective Progress.
52. Update pressure tracks.
53. Reveal earned information.
54. Check rest and extraction options.
55. Choose the next node.

Scene Types and Node Record

Scene types are Investigation, Social, Infiltration, Combat, Chase, Digital, Aetheric/Psychic, Hazard, Rescue, Mass Battle, Recovery, or Hybrid. Every node records location, entry conditions, objective, opposition, encounter class, Recovery Load, pressure triggers, clues, success, failure, botch, exit routes, Support Assets, and rest status.

Mission Pressure Tracks

A mission normally uses one or two 0-6 pressure tracks. At 2 pressure becomes visible, at 4 it materially complicates the mission, and at 6 the defined crisis occurs. Pressure rises only from established triggers.

Track	0-6 Meaning
Alert	Unaware; anomaly; security alerted; active search; lockdown/reinforcements; full hunt; strategic response.
Deadline	Ample time; advancing; narrowing; final preparations; final window; immediate action; event occurs.
Escalation	Initial opposition through local response, specialists, elite response, strategic weapon, and full crisis.
Collateral	No harm through property loss, injuries, infrastructure failure, mass-casualty risk, disaster, and catastrophe.
Exposure	Secure through rumors, patterns, investigation, probable identity link, confirmed evidence, and public/enemy exposure.
Instability	Stable through fluctuation, interference, active hazard, system failure, collapse imminent, and collapse.

Track	0-6 Meaning
Political Pressure	Supported through scrutiny, oversight, restriction, intervention, withdrawal, and sanctions/arrest/conflict.
Pursuit	No trail through evidence, route, track, closing hunters, imminent intercept, and active Chase/ambush.

Rest During a Mission

Rest	Mission Effect
Breather	Uses normal ten-minute recovery; requires temporary safety.
Short Rest	Requires a secure or defensible location. During an active mission normally advances Deadline, Alert, Escalation, Pursuit, or Instability by 1 unless a recovery window was secured.
Full Rest	Normally ends the current operational phase. During an unresolved mission advances a major pressure track by 2 or allows a significant enemy countermove.

Rules of Engagement and Constraints

Rules of Engagement may require nonlethal force, capture alive, civilian safety, evidence preservation, secrecy, jurisdiction, identity protection, no collateral, restricted Aether or psychic use, or preservation of a target. Violations create defined consequences rather than retroactively invalidating actions. Constraints are practical limitations such as a deadline, no communication, limited oxygen, one Gate, public location, unstable dimension, or no Full Rest.

Reversal and Climax

A reversal should create a meaningful choice rather than merely adding enemies. It may trigger at pressure 4-6, reveal a hidden complication, change the objective, fail a Support Asset, activate an enemy countermove, compromise extraction, or begin mass combat. It should not negate successful planning without evidence or require one undisclosed specific Power.

The Climax directly resolves the Primary Objective and should reflect Intelligence, Prepared Advantages, Support Assets, pressure, and earlier success or failure.

Extraction

State	Rule
Secure	Route controlled; no separate roll.
Contested	One final scene or Chase; prepared extraction normally begins Distance 4, otherwise 2-3.
Compromised	Begin Distance 1-2; one support function may be unavailable.
Lost	Create a new route, hide, seize transport, open a Gate, negotiate, hold for rescue, surrender, or abandon assets.

Parallel Operations

Each subteam resolves one Scene Node per Mission Interval. Shared pressure tracks update after all subteams act. A subteam's failure may affect the others. Balance encounters using only participating characters. The longest relevant scene determines the shared narrative interval.

Debrief and Advancement

- Record objective outcome, casualties, injuries, civilians, Collateral, resources, equipment damage, Background state, Reputation, Threat Class, Lair Pressure, legal/faction consequences, intelligence, unresolved threats, XP, and downtime needs.
- A substantial mission normally awards 3 group XP, +1 for the Primary Objective, +1 for major risk/sacrifice/accepted consequence, +1 for a major milestone or discovery, and an additional 3-8 for an arc finale. Typical missions award 3-5; finales 6-12.

16. Downtime and Long-Term Projects | Training, research, recovery, and construction

Downtime Actions

Downtime Period	Actions
1-3 days	1
1 week	2
1 month	4
3 months	8
6 months	12
1 year	20

One Downtime Action represents one major focused commitment. It completes a minor activity or funds one project interval. Interval time still limits how many rolls occur. Rushing costs 2 DA for one extra interval, applies -2 ordinary dice, and adds 1 Instability.

Training Time

Training Scope	DA
Days	1
Weeks	2
Months	4
Major downtime or arc	8
Major arc or rare source	12

Accelerated training uses a difficulty-3 roll. Success reduces DA by 1, minimum 1; botch adds 1 DA and a complication. XP and prerequisites remain required.

Project Complexity

Complexity	Threshold	Difficulty	Max Intervals	Typical Interval
Minor	5	1	3	Hour or day
Standard	10	2	5	Day
Complex	15	3	6	Day or week
Major	25	4	8	Week
Legendary	40	5	10	Week or month
Planetary	60	6	12	Month
Interstellar	100	7	15	Month or season
Cosmic	150+	GM	Story-defined	Season, year, or story

Project Facilities and Background Minimums

Facility	Rating
Improvised	0
Professional	1
Advanced	2
Strategic	3
Civilization	4
Unique/Cosmic	5

One facility level short imposes -3 ordinary dice; two short -5 and a Quality cap; three short is impossible. Suggested Background minimums by Complexity are 0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, and 9-10. One point short adds +2 difficulty or an Obligation; two or more points short is normally impossible.

Instability and Breakthrough Points

Starting Instability is normally 0 for established work, 1 novel, 2 alien or experimental, and 3 forbidden, Reality-adjacent, resurrection, or existential work. At Instability 3 apply -1 die; at 5 apply -2 and failures create setbacks; at 6 a crisis occurs and work pauses.

A stabilization action uses difficulty 2; every 3 final successes remove 1 Instability, Critical removes 2 or a setback. A Critical project interval may generate 1 Breakthrough Point. Spend 1 BP to add 5 Progress, remove 2 Instability, remove a setback, temporarily satisfy a nonunique requirement, create a bonus discovery, or improve Quality.

Partial Results and Completion

Progress	Result
25%	Preliminary information or proof of concept
50%	Limited prototype, partial agreement, or temporary result
75%	Field-usable result with one Defect or reduced Scale
100%	Intended result, subject to Instability and Quality

Instability at Completion	State
0-2	Functional
3-4	Compromised
5	Unstable
6	Crisis

Downtime Activities

- Training
- Research
- Healing and rehabilitation
- Repair
- Crafting
- Background recovery
- Reputation management
- Investigation
- Building Contacts
- Organizational work
- Power development
- Power stunts
- Reducing Flaws
- Long-term rituals

Project Templates

Project	Complexity	Threshold	Interval	Lead	Facility	Instability
Medical research	Complex	15	Week	Medicine/Science	2	1
Cure major disease	Major	25	Week	Medicine	2-3	2
Engineering prototype	Major	25	Week	Engineering	2-3	2
Artifact construction	Legendary	40	Month	Aethercraft/Engineering	3+	2
Political campaign	Major	25	Week	Persuasion/Influence	Organizational	1
Historical investigation	Complex	15	Week	Academics/Investigation	Archive 1-2	1
Background recovery	Standard/Complex	10-15	Day/Week	Relevant Skill	Variable	0
Reputation repair	Major	25	Week	Persuasion/Performance	Communications	1
Power development	Standard-Legendary	10-40	Week/Month	Power/Aethercraft	Training 1-4	1-3
Suppression design	Major	25	Week	Engineering/Technology	3	2
Dimensional stabilization	Planetary	60	Month	Gate/Science/Aethercraft	4-5	3
Planetary ward	Planetary	60	Month	Aethercraft	4	3

Project	Complexity	Threshold	Interval	Lead	Facility	Instability
Resurrection	Major/Legendary	25-40	Ritual	Soul + Life	3+	3
Civilization evacuation	Planetary	60	Week/Month	Leadership/Strategy/Gate	4	2
Reverse dimensional collapse	Interstellar	100	Season	Gate/Authority/Science	5	3

17. Multi-Team Projects | Parallel Workfronts, automation, organizations, and hostile interference

A large project is divided into Workfronts. Each Workfront has its own threshold, Lead Skill, difficulty, facility, materials, dependencies, interval, Lead, and output. The sum of mandatory Workfront thresholds equals the parent Project threshold. Integration normally receives 10-25% of total Progress when outputs must function together.

Maximum Simultaneous Workfronts

Complexity	Recommended Active Workfronts
Minor	1
Standard	1
Complex	2
Major	3
Legendary	4
Planetary	5
Interstellar	6
Cosmic	8

Work Teams

One Team consists of one Lead and up to five helpers using normal Teamwork. Each character participates in only one Team per project interval. Larger bodies use an abstract Work-Team Quality profile.

Quality	Pool
Amateur 0	4 dice
Green 1	6 dice
Professional 2	8 dice
Expert 3	10 dice
Elite 4	10 dice +2 automatic successes
Legendary 5	10 dice +4 automatic successes

A narrow Specialty grants +2 ordinary dice; a Weakness imposes -2.

Primary and Support Teams

- Each Workfront has one Primary Team. Its successful roll adds final successes as Progress. A Critical may generate 1 Breakthrough Point, maximum one per Workfront per interval.
- Additional Teams on one indivisible Workfront are Support Teams. Success adds 1 Support Progress; Critical 2; failure 0; botch removes 1 Progress or adds 1 Instability. Support Progress is capped at 3 per Workfront per interval.
- Divisible labor should be separated into parallel Workfronts rather than stacked as unlimited Support Teams.

Project Director

The Director manages assignments, standards, dependencies, shared Breakthrough Points, decisions, communication, and final acceptance. Coordination Capacity equals 1 + half the higher of Leadership or Strategy, rounded up, maximum 6. Workfronts beyond capacity follow standing orders, cannot share Breakthrough Points, and gain 1 Interface Debt when completed unless overseen by a deputy.

Coordination Tests

A Coordination Test is required when three or more Teams act in one interval, disciplines or factions are incompatible, active Workfronts exceed normal capacity, a major design change occurs, or communication is degraded. Roll Intelligence/Wits + Strategy or Charisma/Resolve + Leadership, base difficulty 2. Add +1 per two Teams beyond three, +1 for major incompatibility, +1 for rival authority, +1 for Degraded communication, or +2 for Severed delayed coordination.

Result	Effect
Success	Normal operation
Critical	Choose: +2 one Workfront; transfer 1 BP; remove 1 Interface Debt; prevent 1 Instability; start dependency early; allow +1 Support Progress beyond cap
Failure	One Primary Team contributes half Progress and project gains 1 Instability
Botch	Remove 3 Progress, add 2 Instability, add 1 Interface Debt, and create a setback

Dependencies and Interface Debt

Dependency	Rule
Hard	Dependent Workfront cannot begin until prerequisite is complete.
Soft	May begin at -2 dice; failure adds 1 Instability until prerequisite completes.
Shared Resource	Only one Workfront uses the unique facility, component, specialist, dataset, or source at a time.
Milestone	May begin when prerequisite reaches specified Progress.
Decision	Pauses until a choice, consent, or authorization occurs.

Interface Debt comes from incompatible standards, foreign technology, abrupt lead changes, shortcuts, missing documentation, rival teams, or unsupervised work. Every two Interface Debt add +1 Integration difficulty, maximum +3. A stabilization action removes 1 Debt per 3 final successes.

Facility Capacity and Materials

Concurrent Team Capacity equals 1 + Facility Rating, maximum 6. Each Team beyond capacity suffers -3 ordinary dice and consumes 1 additional Supply Unit per interval. Missing materials require pausing, substitutes, -3 dice, a Defect, Instability, reduced Quality, or a defined maintenance burden.

Downtime and Automation

Each active player character spends 1 DA per project interval as Lead or helper. A Director spends 1 DA for direct oversight. A character serving as both Director and Lead uses one DA but suffers -2 dice to Coordination or the Workfront unless a feature removes divided attention.

- Automation uses the same Quality pools and requires a complete blueprint, defined inputs, predictable procedures, compatible facilities, and safety instructions.
- Automation cannot ordinarily lead novel conceptual research, moral judgment, diplomacy, new soul creation, identity reconstruction, unbounded Aether work, Reality Authority work, or consent-sensitive decisions.
- Unsupervised automation botches add 2 Instability and a Defect. Non-sapient automation cannot generate Breakthrough Points.

Organizational Contributions

Background/Asset	Contribution
Resources	Materials, Supply, wages, procurement, transport
Retainers	Completed or abstract Work Teams
Allies/Patron	Temporary teams, specialists, facilities, data, or protection
Safe Haven	Facilities and module capacity
Equipment Access	Tools, hardware, prototypes, testing equipment
Status/Clearance/Influence	Permission, classified data, institutional cooperation, deployment authority
Contacts	Information, suppliers, experts, historical data

Projects During Adventures

A Workfront continues while player characters adventure when it has a qualified Lead, facility, materials, standing orders, communication or contingency, and no unresolved Decision Dependency. Without spending a DA on oversight, a player cannot change plans, spend shared BP, reassign teams, accept major obligations, or resolve unexpected decision points until contact resumes.

Work Type	Reliable Standing Orders
Novel research	1 interval
Established development	2 intervals
Routine fabrication	3 intervals
Fully automated production	Until disrupted

Lead Handoffs

At an interval boundary, roll Intelligence + relevant Skill, Charisma + Leadership, or Wits + Strategy, difficulty 2. Success transfers cleanly; Critical grants +2 on the new Lead's first roll; failure gives -2 next interval; botch removes 3 Progress and adds 1 Interface Debt and 1 Instability. A designated deputy may continue one interval at -1 die after abrupt loss; otherwise the Workfront pauses.

Hostile Interference

Sabotage, cyberattack, theft, espionage, political obstruction, facility attack, or a counterproject generates Disruption Points. Success creates 1 DP; Critical 2.

DP	Possible Effect
1	Increase next difficulty by 1; add 1 Instability; block BP spending; -2 one Support Team; raise Exposure; delay materials.
2	Remove 3 Progress; consume 1 Supply; disable a facility one interval; add 1 Interface Debt; corrupt data; force handoff; reveal classified Workfront.
3	Pause a Workfront; steal prototype/data; destroy a nonprotected unique component; legal injunction; facility breach; deploy hostile countermeasure; create ownership dispute.

Every two final successes on a defensive security, counterintelligence, legal, or repair action remove 1 DP. Critical may identify the hostile actor, create false data, gain +2 against the next interference, convert the attack into a mission node, or reduce Project Exposure.

Integration, Validation, and Ownership

Integration uses an appropriate technical or Aetheric pool against parent difficulty plus Interface Debt. Failure adds no Progress and may add Instability; botch removes 3 Integration Progress, adds 2 Instability, compromises a completed Workfront, creates a Defect, or damages a unique component.

Final validation uses the project difficulty. Critical improves Quality, removes 1 Instability or a Defect, preserves Supply, or creates a documented improvement. Failure requires one additional allowed interval or 5 more Integration/Validation Progress and adds 1 Instability. Botch creates an Unstable project and a crisis scene.

Ownership Category	Meaning
Open	Publicly available
Shared	Named contributors or organizations share access
Restricted	Permission or Clearance required
Proprietary	One owner controls production and use
Classified	Knowledge restricted by security
Personal/Bonded	Tied to a character, soul, bloodline, artifact, or Power
Sentient	Possesses selfhood and cannot be treated only as property

Maximum Intervals and Failure

The parent Project maximum counts project intervals, not team rolls. Parallel Teams do not consume extra maximum rolls. At the limit, use the achieved partial result, begin a redesign or recovery project, or declare the current method unable to reach the intended result. Identical unlimited additional rolls are not allowed without changed conditions.

18. Safe Havens and Lairs | Permanent bases, sanctuaries, headquarters, and heroic operations

Safe Haven is an external Background rated 1-10. A Lair is a Safe Haven subtype designed for superheroes and vigilantes. It uses the same construction system but adds identity protection, mission preparation, Pressure, a Signature Feature, and a mandatory Liability.

Safe Haven Rating

Rating	Capability	Capacity	Module Cap	Base Security	Core Structure/Hardness
1	Safe room, hidden chamber, small workshop	4	1	2	25/2
2	Apartment base, hideout, private clinic	6	1	3	35/3
3	House, warehouse, small bunker	8	2	3	45/4
4	Fortified compound or team base	10	2	4	55/5
5	Major headquarters or secure campus	12	3	4	65/6
6	Strategic complex or elite superhuman base	14	3	5	75/7
7	Planetary fortress or civilization facility	16	4	5	85/8
8	Interstellar stronghold or distributed sanctuary	18	4	6	95/9
9	Galactic sanctuary, archive, or command nexus	20	5	6	105/10
10	Unique cosmic bastion	22	5	7	115/11

Capacity Points equal 2 + twice Safe Haven Rating. A module costs Capacity equal to its rating. Maximum Module Rating equals half Safe Haven Rating, rounded up, maximum 5. Rating measures capability and reliability, not mandatory physical size.

Configuration and Visibility

Configuration	Effect
Compact	Capacity -2, minimum 2; +2 physical Concealment; limited occupancy and storage.
Standard	No modifier.
Expansive	Capacity +2; -2 Concealment; easier sectional division.
Distributed	Several linked nodes; first node loss does not make Haven Unavailable; network compromise may expose several nodes.

Visibility	Meaning
Public	Location openly known
Restricted	Existence known; layout, functions, or access controlled
Secret	Location intended to remain unknown; uses Base Security +1 as initial Concealment without a module

Modules

Module Rating	Capability	Onsite Bonus
1	Professional	+1
2	Advanced	+1
3	Strategic	+2
4	Civilization-scale	+2
5	Unique/Cosmic	+3

The full module rating counts as Facility Rating for projects. Section Structure equals 10 + five times Safe Haven Rating + five times Module Rating. At half Structure the module is Impaired: active bonus -1 and facility rating -1. At 0 it is Disabled.

Module Catalogue

Module	Core Rule
Security and Access	Security Rating 3 + twice Module Rating; locks, barriers, identity verification, lockdown. No guards automatically.
Concealment and Masking	Concealment Rating 3 + twice rating. Rating 1 covers ordinary visual/records; each further rating adds thermal, acoustic, electronic, biometric, psychic, Aetheric, dimensional, or Reality signature.
Surveillance and Early Warning	Sensor Rating 3 + twice rating; coverage expands from facility/perimeter to local, regional/orbital, planetary, and interstellar/dimensional.
Cybersecurity	Digital Security 3 + twice rating; Integrity 10 + five times rating; Digital Hardness 1 + rating.
Medical and Recovery	Facility for Medicine, surgery, rehabilitation, and reconstruction. Rating 3+ supports major biological reconstruction with a valid method.
Workshop and Fabrication	Facility for Engineering, Technology, repair, cybernetics, powered armor, and fabrication. Materials remain separate.
Research Laboratory	Choose one principal discipline per rating; provides Facility Rating and active bonus.
Aetheric Chamber	Supports Aethercraft, rituals, wards, and enchantment. Rating 3 reduces starting Ritual Instability 1; Rating 5 reduces 2.
Training and Simulation	Supports combat, Power control, hazards, Skill training, and team coordination. Adds module bonus to accelerated training.
Command and Operations	Supports Strategy, Leadership, tactical mapping, deployment, and mission preparation.
Archives and Intelligence	Choose one archive domain per rating; supports Academics, Investigation, Xenology, or Strategy.
Communications and Relay	Reliable reach: planetary, orbital, interstellar, galactic, intergalactic/dimensional by ratings 1-5.
Power Core	Site Reserve equals five times rating. Recover 1 per ten-minute service, 25% per short service, all per full service.
Environmental Control	Choose one hazard family per rating; protects occupants from ordinary versions while functional.
Containment	Suppression/Containment Rating 3 + twice rating. Choose one type per rating; broad containment operates at effective rating -2.
Armory and Storage	Supports maximum Grade rating +1, restores ordinary ammunition and purchased consumables, and protects stored gear. Does not create ownership.
Drone and Automation	Supports two drones per rating, charging, repair, remote control, and maintenance.
Escape and Extraction	One reliable route per rating. Successful evacuation begins Chase Distance 2 + rating, maximum 5.
Habitation and Sanctuary	Supports a household, teams, organization wing, population refuge, or civilization sanctuary by rating.
Dimensional/Reality Anchor	Anchor Rating 3 + twice rating against teleportation, phasing, displacement, and collapse.
Secure Vault	Uses Security by rating, Section Structure +10, Hardness +2, and may integrate Containment, Cybersecurity, or wards.

Operational States and Damage

State	Effect
Ready	All functions normal.
Strained	One module -1 effective rating, Site Reserve recovery halved, or one facility benefit unavailable.
Compromised	Security and Concealment -2; one layer known; Lair gains Pressure.
Breached	Intruders entered a protected section or critical section reaches 0 Structure; modules may be directly targeted.
Unavailable	Cannot safely or practically be used due to occupation, severe damage, seizure, isolation, or collapse.
Lost	Destroyed, permanently captured, or irrecoverable; purchased asset requires recovery, replacement, rebuild, refund, or player-approved reconstruction.

At half Core Structure the Haven becomes Strained and one module is Impaired. At 0 it becomes Breached and Unavailable; modules lose power unless independently supplied. Major repair thresholds are 5 for an Impaired module, 10 for Disabled, 15 for a breached section, 25 to restore a core from 0, and 40+ to rebuild a destroyed Haven.

Shared Havens

Use the highest contributor's Safe Haven Rating. Additional owners add Capacity equal to contributed Safe Haven dots, maximum +5 total. Contributions do not raise Rating, Module Cap, Core Structure, or Base Security. Contributing owners receive Background-loss protection; guests do not.

Lair Profile

A Lair normally requires Safe Haven 2+. Record Lair name, heroic identity, civilian cover, visibility, configuration, archetype, access method, Signature Feature, Liability, emergency protocol, Pressure, modules, and Prepared Advantages.

A Secret or Restricted Lair grants +2 ordinary dice to resist linking heroic and civilian identities while Pressure is 0-2. Definitive witnesses or evidence bypass this benefit.

Lair Archetypes

Archetype	Benefit	Limitation
Cave/Bunker	+2 physical Concealment and +1 Core Hardness against bombardment/collapse	Without Communications or Escape, remote contact and deployment take longer
Urban Facade	+2 Deception to maintain civilian cover and easy urban access	Public disturbance nearby may add Pressure
Public Tower/HQ	+2 Leadership/public coordination from the Lair	Location cannot be concealed; Pressure is hostile attention
Wilderness Sanctuary	+2 physical Concealment and +2 Survival in territory	Distant deployment is slower without transport/Gate
Aetheric Sanctum	Aetheric Chamber counts one rating higher only for reducing Ritual Instability	Active magic gives Aetheric detection +2 dice
Alien/Ancient Vault	Workshop or Research counts one rating higher for one alien technology family	Repairs require Xenology/specialists; missing components create Instability
Dimensional Pocket	+3 Concealment against ordinary physical/electronic investigation	Anchor failure adds 2 Instability and may trap occupants
Distributed Network	Losing one node does not make Lair Unavailable; one node may be a decoy	Trace or network compromise may add Pressure to all nodes

Signature Features and Liabilities

Every Lair receives one free narrow Signature Feature comparable to a one-point feature: +2 to one narrow Lair action, one special access method, one minor once-per-scene function, or distinctive narrative permission. It cannot grant a full Power or unrestricted extra action.

Liability	Consequence
Distinctive Signature	Specialized tracking +2 dice after systems are observed
Anchor Dependency	Destroying the anchor disables one major module and Strains the Haven
Civilian Proximity	Attacks risk civilians and Reputation
Power Hunger	Major use Strains the Lair without a Power Core
Legacy Systems	A module botch creates one additional complication
Restricted Access	Only one narrow normal route
Public Exposure	Enemies may plan attacks without locating the Lair
Sentient System	Controller has motives, rights, and potential conflict
Trophy Risk	Stored artifacts/evidence can expose identities or create danger
Territorial Bond	Owner Powers or stability are tied to the Lair

Lair Pressure

Pressure	State
0	Unknown/routine
1	Rumors
2	Operational pattern recognized
3	Targeted investigation
4	Perimeter compromised
5	Active breach preparation
6	Exposed or under assault

- At 3, hostile investigation gains +2 and identity separation no longer applies automatically.
- At 4, one outer layer and one route/system/routine are known.
- At 5, attackers may begin infiltration at Progress 1 and know a module or weakness.
- At 6, the relevant enemy knows the location; the Lair becomes Compromised and attackers may begin at Progress 2.
- Pressure rises from repeated routes, being followed, digital Trace, public signature use, evidence, failed cleanup, infiltration botches, or captured credentials.

- A Lay Low action costs 1 DA and uses Stealth, Deception, Technology, or Aethercraft at difficulty 2; success reduces 1, Critical 2. False trails, cleanup, decoys, and relocation may also reduce Pressure.

Lair Specializations

Each specialization costs 1 Capacity and normally requires a supporting module.

Specialization	Effect
Identity Vault	+2 against identity exposure through stored records; emergency purge
Forensic Suite	+2 one forensic category and preserved samples
Trophy/Artifact Vault	+2 Security against theft and separated dangerous storage
Threat Archive	Once per mission ask one narrow documented-threat question and gain +2 to the first action exploiting it
Mission Control	One remote team receives Command module bonus once per scene
Rapid Deployment Hub	Reduce one deployment interval by one step; once per mission begin response one Chase band closer
Suit Forge	+2 repair, recalibration, or modification of one signature suit/weapon
Power Calibration Chamber	+2 Power-control, Center Power, or safe Overcharge preparation before mission
Simulation Arena	Reproduce one known tactical or environmental scenario; +2 preparation
Recovery Chamber	First Short Rest after a mission heals +2 Superficial and may stabilize one temporary Condition, once per character per Full Rest
Decoy Lair	Once per arc redirect one investigation or breach attempt; discovery adds 1 Pressure
Watch Network	+2 monitor a defined region, organization, or threat and begin a mission with warning or clue
Detention Vault	One cell +2 Containment Rating
Emergency Sanctuary	Safely houses civilians/allies and grants +2 to morale/basic survival

Lair Mission Preparation

Spend at least one hour using a relevant module and roll Attribute + Skill + module bonus, difficulty 2. Success generates one Prepared Advantage; Critical two. Team maximum remains three.

- Equipment Cache
- Threat Dossier
- Countermeasure
- Planned Route
- Extraction Plan
- Medical Preparation
- Power Calibration
- Identity Cover

Lair Breaches

A Secret Lair must normally be located by defeating Concealment through Investigation, surveillance, Trace, following, psychic or Aetheric detection, betrayal, or evidence. Once located, use infiltration Progress 0-6 and Alarm 0-6. Security, Cybersecurity, Surveillance, Aetheric defenses, Anchoring, and Containment provide opposition.

Progress	Breach Result
1	Perimeter reached
2	Initial access gained
3	Internal systems penetrated
4	Outer module targetable
5	Core, Identity Vault, or primary objective accessible
6	Objective seized, core breached, or Lair occupied

Once per breach, Lockdown grants +2 defense to one layer and prevents enemy Progress from increasing by more than 1 during the next exchange, but seals one escape route. A functioning Escape module begins evacuation at Distance 2 + rating, maximum 5.

19. Mass Combat | Formations, command, objectives, supply, and heroes at war

Mass Combat is an objective-driven Formation system. A Formation is an independently commanded military body acting as one entity. Magnitude measures numbers and operational footprint. It is separate from Potency, Area, Movement, and Structure Scale.

Resolution Levels and Magnitude

Resolution	Typical Magnitudes	Battle Turn
Tactical	M0-M2	1-5 minutes
Operational	M2-M4	10-60 minutes
Strategic	M4-M7	6-24 hours
Planetary	M6-M8	One day or longer

Magnitude	Typical Formation
M0	Team/fireteam, 2-5
M1	Squad, 6-15
M2	Platoon, 16-50
M3	Company, 51-200
M4	Battalion, 201-1,000
M5	Regiment/brigade, 1,001-5,000
M6	Division/army, 5,001-50,000
M7	Host/theater, 50,001-500,000
M8	Planetary force, 500,000+ or distributed worldwide

Quality and Abstract Pools

Quality	Name	Action	Defense	Morale
0	Mob	4	3	4
1	Green	6	5	5
2	Trained	8	7	7
3	Veteran	10	9	9
4	Elite	10 +2 autos	10 +1 auto	10 +2 autos
5	Legendary	10 +4 autos	10 +3 autos	10 +4 autos

Detailed Formations use representative completed pools such as Dexterity + Firearms, Intelligence + Heavy Weapons, Dexterity + Piloting, or governing Attribute + Power. Quality is not added again to detailed pools.

Cohesion

Maximum Cohesion equals 10 + four times Magnitude + twice Quality. Cohesion represents personnel, organization, morale, ammunition, functional equipment, communication, command integrity, and ability to continue fighting. Cohesion retains Superficial, Lethal, Aggravated, and Annihilation damage types.

Remaining Cohesion	State	Effect
Above 75%	Ready	No penalty
51-75%	Disrupted	-1 Initiative and Command reception
26-50%	Shaken	-1 formation-action die and immediate Morale Test
1-25%	Broken	-2 action dice; no Assault/Rapid Advance without Rally; test Morale each round
0	Defeated	Rout, surrender, dispersal, destruction, or annihilation

Formation Profile

- Name, side, Magnitude, Quality, type, and domains
- Maximum/current Cohesion by damage type
- Attack pools, defense modes, Morale, BD, AP, range, Protection
- Mobility 0-5, Supply 0-6, sensors, concealment, command link
- Representative Reserve and Strain for powered Formations
- Tags, attachments, objective, and standing order

Battle Sequence

56. Situation Phase: hazards, reinforcements, clocks, ongoing effects, supply routes, hidden events.
57. Command Phase: orders, Command Test, bonuses, communications.
58. Initiative: Wits + Strategy by side; winner chooses first or second; alternate Formation activations.
59. Formation Activations: each Formation receives one Standard, one Movement, one Reaction, and free communication.
60. Morale and Objectives: tests, rout, surrender, Progress, Domain Control.
61. Supply and End: costs, upkeep, Strain, fortification damage, arrivals, Conditions.

Command

Command Capacity equals 1 + half Leadership rounded up, maximum 6 before HQ or other benefits. A commander coordinates only that many Formations; others continue standing orders.

Command Test: Intelligence/Wits + Strategy or Charisma/Resolve + Leadership, normally difficulty 2. Meeting difficulty grants +1 Command die, beating by 2 grants +2, beating by 4 grants +3. Apply to Formations within capacity and communication.

Command Link	Effect
Clear	Normal
Degraded	Command bonus maximum +1; changing orders costs a Standard Action
Severed	No Command bonus; standing orders only; Morale difficulty +1; no complex coordination

Domains and Mobility

Domains are Ground, Air, Sea, Orbit, Cyber, Aether, and Dimensional. A Formation needs appropriate Reach to affect another domain. Unopposed Domain Control grants +2 ordinary dice to Recon, Maneuver, Resupply, or Interdiction in that domain.

Mobility	Capability
0	Static/entrenched
1	Foot or slow ground
2	Mechanized or fast ground
3	Airborne, Super Speed, fast aquatic
4	Orbital or strategic teleportation
5	Interstellar, Gate network, exceptional strategic movement

Formation Defense and Damage

Maneuver Defense uses Dexterity + Athletics, Wits + Strategy, Dexterity + Piloting, or abstract Defense. Brace uses Stamina + Athletics, Resolve + Leadership, or abstract Defense plus fortification. Counterfire uses Wits + combat Skill, Intelligence + Heavy Weapons, or the abstract Action Pool. Passive Defense is the active pool divided by 4 rounded up plus automatic successes.

Formation Raw Damage equals representative Base Damage + attacker Magnitude + net successes + listed support. Then apply Protection, AP, resistance, vulnerability, damage type, and Scale. Magnitude increases coordinated volume, not Potency Scale.

Magnitude Differential

Difference	Global Cohesion Rule
Equal or one step smaller	Normal Cohesion damage
Two steps smaller	Half final Cohesion damage after mitigation

Difference	Global Cohesion Rule
Three or more smaller	Cannot damage global Cohesion without Area, Scale-Breaker, Combined force, ambush, choke point, weak point, strategic weapon, objective action, or infiltration

A smaller Formation may still target commanders, attachments, supply, fortifications, sensors, and exposed assets. A larger Formation does not gain extra actions from size; it must Split to act independently in several places.

Core Formation Actions

Action	Rule
Fire/Engage	Normal Formation attack.
Assault	Full; move one Zone and attack; +1 BD, -2 defense until next activation.
Bombard	Full; artillery/strategic permission; +2 Raw vs fortifications; costs 1 Supply.
Concentrated Fire	-2 attack dice; gain +2 AP or target commander, hero, attachment, fortification, vehicle, Gate, shield, or relay.
Suppress	Half normal Cohesion damage, minimum 1, and Pressured/Suppressed 1; Critical severity 2 or deny Movement.
Flank	Maneuver contest; success gives Exposed 1 and -2 defense against next allied attack; Critical removes Reaction and forces Morale.
Defend/Hold	+2 defense and Morale; enables Counterfire, Brace, or Screen.
Entrench	Full; Engineering/Strategy difficulty 2; every 3 successes create one Fortification Rating, max one per turn.
Recon	Detect hidden Formation, attachment, route, weakness, command post, objective, or decoy. Critical reveals two and grants +2 exploitation.
Screen	Protect one Formation, route, or objective and Intercept with Reaction.
Rally	Leadership; every 2 successes reduce morale Condition, end Fall Back, restore formation, or reconsider surrender.
Reorganize	Full; every 3 successes restore 1 Superficial Cohesion, max 3 per battle.
Resupply/Repair	Full; every 3 successes restore one Supply, minor asset function, 5 barrier Structure, or minor disabled system.
Seize Objective	Relevant action; success +1 Progress, Critical +2.
Withdraw/Pursue	Use formation Chase rules.
Electronic/Aetheric Warfare	Use Digital or Aetheric systems to degrade command, sensors, wards, Gates, or objectives.
Mass Power	Use normal Power action with formation rules.
Split/Merge	Full; divide into smaller independent Formations or combine compatible adjacent Formations.

Reactions and Critical Benefits

- Maneuver Defense
- Brace: +2 Stability, +1 Protection, resist forced movement, no movement before next activation
- Counterfire
- Intercept
- Emergency Shield

A Formation Critical may add +3 Raw Damage, +2 AP, force Morale, push one Zone, disable an attachment, reduce Supply, degrade Command, breach fortification, apply Pressured, gain Objective Progress, or cut a route.

Fortifications

Rating	Type	Defense	Protection	Structure	Special
1	Fieldworks	+1	1	15	Trenches/barricades
2	Entrenched	+2	2	25	Bunkers/hardened position
3	Hardened	+3	4	40	Military strongpoint
4	Fortress	+3	6	60	Scale-Hardened 1
5	Planetary Bastion	+3	8	100	Scale-Hardened 2

Target fortification Structure instead of the Formation. At half Structure defense falls by 1. At 0 the section is breached and its Protection and defense end.

Supply

Supply	State	Effect
4-6	Ready	No penalty
2-3	Low	-1 attacks, repair, recovery; heavy actions may cost +1 Supply
1	Critical	-2 action dice, Mobility -1, no Bombard or barrier refresh, Morale Test
0	Cut Off	-3 action dice, no heavy actions, Morale Test each turn

Bombardment, strategic Rapid Advance, major barrier recharge, heavy repair, mass Power rating 7+, sustained strategic Flight, large suppression, and emergency medical restoration normally cost 1 Supply. Without a valid line, lose 1 Supply each Strategic or Planetary Battle Turn.

Attachments

Attachment	Benefit
Artillery battery	+2 Formation BD and Bombard permission
Medical corps	+2 casualty and Lethal recovery
Engineer corps	+2 Entrench, Repair, and Breach
Shield generator	Barrier Structure 15, Protection 3
Suppression battery	SR 8, SV 2 typed suppression
Recon wing	+2 Recon and pursuit detection
Logistics train	+2 Resupply and stores 2 Supply
Command headquarters	+1 Command Capacity and +1 Command die
Air/orbital support	Cross-domain attack, Screen, sensors, or Bombard
Gate team	Strategic movement and extraction
Aether ritual circle	Supports mass rituals and wards
Cyberwarfare cell	+2 Electronic Warfare
Propaganda unit	+2 Morale pressure or Reputation action
Evacuation team	+2 civilian extraction or retreat

Target an exposed attachment at -2 attack dice. Light, Standard, Heavy, and Strategic attachments have Structure/Hardness 10/2, 20/4, 30/6, and 40+/8+.

Powered Formations

A Formation in which at least half the members share a Power may use it as a Formation Power. Use the representative Power pool, Reserve, and Strain; do not multiply resources by troop count. Power damage equals Power BD + Magnitude + net successes. Magnitude grants coverage, not Potency Scale. Combined Powers use one support roll per participating Formation.

Heroes in Mass Combat

Each player character chooses one role per Battle Turn: Command, Embedded Support, Independent Hero Action, or Strategic Action. They do not receive the full benefits of several roles in one turn.

Role	Function
Command	Command a Formation or contribute to side Command Test
Embedded Support	Grant +1 Teamwork die, protect Formation, use support Power, or add a specialty
Independent Hero Action	Attack Formation, destroy attachment, duel champion, rescue, sabotage, open Gate, protect objective
Strategic Action	Ritual, shutdown, negotiation, evacuation, command-system hack, or other objective action

Hero Attacks and Formation Attacks

A hero converts each full 5 post-mitigation personal damage into 1 Cohesion, minimum 1 when meaningful damage and coverage exist.

Coverage	Cohesion Cap
Single target	1
Cluster	2
Small Area	3
One Zone	5
Several Zones	8
Strategic Area	Uncapped

Each Potency Scale step above the relevant defense may raise the cap by 1, maximum +3. A hero may instead destroy an attachment, capture a commander, force Morale, add Objective Progress, breach fortification, cut supply, or protect an ally.

A Formation uses Concentrated Fire to target an individual hero unless the attack naturally covers the hero. Use representative attack pool and Base Damage + the lower of Magnitude or 5 + net successes, then apply personal defense, Protection, AP, cover, and Scale.

Healing and Barriers

Every full 5 Health restored across Formation members restores 1 Lethal Cohesion, limited by Area and source, once per Battle Turn per healing source. Every 5 relevant barrier Structure lost prevents 1 Cohesion damage, subject to coverage.

Morale, Objectives, and Withdrawal

Mass Morale triggers include commander loss, crossing 50% or 25% Cohesion, losing 25% maximum in one turn, objective loss, encirclement, Supply 1 or 0, Annihilation, allied rout, overwhelming Scale, or a force two Magnitudes larger. Use the existing Morale system.

Objectives normally use Progress 0-6: Hold, Capture, Breakthrough, Destroy, Escort, Evacuate, Delay, Survive, Control Domain, Ritual, Rescue, or Cut Supply.

Controlled withdrawal begins a formation Chase at Distance 2; prepared extraction 3-5; Rout 1; surrounded 0-1. Distance 6 escapes; Distance 0 permits assault, encirclement, capture, or surrender.

Post-Battle Casualties and Recovery

Remaining Cohesion	Typical Permanent Loss
Above 75%	0-5%
51-75%	5-15%
26-50%	15-30%
1-25%	30-50%
0 through surrender/rout	20-40% removed; many captured/scattered
0 through Lethal collapse	50-75%
0 through Aggravated collapse	75-90%
0 through Annihilation	90-100%

- Mostly Superficial damage halves permanent losses; Aggravated raises them 50%; orderly surrender reduces them 25-50%; medical support converts some deaths to wounded; Last Stand raises losses 25%.
- Each full 10% permanent loss reduces maximum Cohesion by 1 until replacements arrive.
- Superficial Cohesion fully recovers after operational rest with command, shelter, and supply. Lethal recovers 1 per Recovery Day with support or 1 per week without. Aggravated recovers 1 per week with strategic support or 1 per month without. Annihilation requires explicit reconstruction and continuity.

20. GM Catalogues and Templates | Ready-to-use security, digital, morale, loadout, and reputation profiles

Security Site Templates

Site	Layers	Typical Ratings	Common Security
Civilian residence	2	1-3	Locks, neighbors, consumer cameras
Commercial building	3	2-4	Access cards, guards, cameras
Criminal safehouse	3	3-5	Lookouts, traps, hidden exits
Government office	4	4-6	Credentials, records, armed response
AEGIS field office	5	6-8	Biometric access, digital security, tactical lockdown
PARAGON facility	5	8-10	Superhuman sensors, suppression, armor
JSS containment center	6	10-13	Strategic suppression and dimensional anchors
Warg House fortress	5	7-11	Pack patrols, territory sensors, fortifications
Alder archive	6	10-14	Aether wards, identity seals, Seer monitoring
Graven Library	6	10-15	Archive AI, core authentication, hardened shells
Interstellar prison	6	11-14	Multi-source suppression, isolation, response forces
Cosmic vault	6+	13-15+	Reality anchors, unique guardians, layered permissions

Alarm	Standard Response
0	Routine
1	Local verification
2	Access review
3	Patrol redirection
4	Lockdown
5	Armed or superhuman response
6	Full containment and reinforcements

Chase Obstacle Templates

Environment	Obstacle	Rating	Failure
City	Dense pedestrians	1	Distance shifts against failing side
City	Traffic crossing	2	Collision BD 3 or Prone
Rooftop	Narrow gap	2	Fall or lose Distance
Rooftop	Unstable roof	3	Prone and structural hazard
Interior	Locked security door	2	Lose one action
Interior	Collapsing stairwell	4	BD 5 and separation
Industrial	Moving machinery	2	Dazed
Industrial	Reactor hazard	5	BD 6 environmental damage
Forest	Dense undergrowth	1	Distance shift
Forest	Hidden ravine	4	Fall and separation
Mountain	Avalanche	5	Area BD 7 and Immobilized
Desert	Dust cloud	3	Concealed 2 and navigation loss
Aquatic	Reef/wreckage	3	Collision BD 4
Aerial	Turbulence	3	Distance shift
Space station	Sealing bulkhead	2	Route closes
Space station	Decompression	5	Vacuum hazard
Super Speed	Sudden civilians	3	Stop or cause Collateral
Super Speed	Inadequate turning space	4	Collision
Dimensional	Shifting geometry	3	Wrong Distance band
Dimensional	Reality fracture	6	Aggravated damage or displacement

Digital System Templates

System	Security	Integrity	Hardness	Functions
Consumer device	1-2	5	0	Personal files and basic controls
Civilian network	2-4	10	1	Accounts, cameras, local systems
Corporate network	4-6	15	2	Restricted data and operations
Government network	5-7	18	3	Classified records and identity systems
Military network	6-9	22	4	Weapons, logistics, tactical systems
AEGIS network	7-10	25	5	Threat files, security, interagency links
PARAGON network	9-11	30	6	Superhuman tracking, deployment, suppression
JSS strategic network	11-13	35	8	Planetary defense and existential threats
Alder Aether-tech	10-14	30	7	Dual Technology/Aethercraft security
Graven archive	10-15	40	9	Memory architecture and sapient defense
Sapient AI domain	Variable	AI Health or 30+	Variable	Active defense and selfhood
Reality-adjacent machine	13-15	50+	10+	Causal or dimensional controls

Morale Doctrines

Doctrine	Behavior
Civilians	Test readily after visible death or blocked escape; prefer Fall Back or Rout.
Criminals	Test after leader loss or failed objective; prefer surrender when survival is credible.
Professional soldiers	Ignore first minor casualty trigger; +1 Rally die in formation.
AEGIS agents	Ignore first expected Threat-Class trigger when briefed; prefer tactical withdrawal.
PARAGON forces	Ignore superior-threat trigger below major superhuman level; more likely defensive Last Stand.
JSS forces	Strong against cosmic fear; test when mission becomes strategically impossible.
Warg House troops	+1 morale while leader or pack bond remains; leader loss is major.
Fanatics	Ignore one ordinary trigger; failures tend toward Last Stand.
Artificial soldiers	Use command Integrity; controller loss or contradictory orders trigger tests.
Mycelyth linked	+2 morale while networked; severance adds +2 difficulty.
Graven defenders	+2 against fear; archive or core loss is major trigger.
Mercenaries	Test when payment, extraction, or survival becomes doubtful.
Rebels	+1 while defending symbolic objective; betrayal is major trigger.

Standard Loadouts

Loadout	EP	Contents
Civilian traveler	3	Communicator, utility kit, emergency shelter
Investigator	7	Service pistol, reinforced clothing, forensic kit, scanner
Crisis responder	7	Baton, body armor, medical kit, communicator
AEGIS field agent	9	Pulse sidearm, field armor, multisensor
AEGIS tactical agent	12	Pulse rifle, field armor, restraints, trauma unit
PARAGON operative	15	PARAGON armor, kinetic lance or restraint projector, power analyzer
JSS operative	18	Strategic armor, high-tier weapon, continuity monitor, dimensional beacon
Medic	9	Body armor, trauma unit, regenerative compound, scanner
Engineer	9	Carbine, engineering kit, hacking rig, breaching charge
Infiltrator	9	Suppressed pistol, infiltration cloak, larceny tools, secure communicator
Psychic containment	12	Psychic collar, ward band, restraint projector, field armor
Aetheric containment	12	Aether seal, masking veil, power analyzer, field armor

Loadout	EP	Contents
Environmental team	12	Strategic suit, scanner, shelter, trauma unit
Warg House warrior	9	Lineage-adapted armor, melee weapon, communicator
Alder specialist	12	Aether focus, field armor, masking veil, dimensional beacon

Reputation Templates

Descriptor	Audience	Rating	Facet	Visibility	Scope
Public hero	General population	3	Admired/Trusted	Public	Planetary
Feared vigilante	Criminal underworld	3	Feared/Mixed	Public	Regional
Trusted investigator	Law enforcement/clients	2	Trusted	Restricted	Regional
Controversial AEGIS operative	AEGIS/public	3	Mixed	Public	Planetary
Criminal legend	Criminal factions	4	Respected/Notorious	Public	Interstellar
Warg oathbreaker	Warg Houses	3	Hated	Public	House territories
Alder scholar	Academic/Aetheric circles	3	Respected	Restricted	Interstellar
Cosmic destroyer	Strategic governments	5	Feared/Notorious	Restricted	Galactic
Secret intelligence asset	Intelligence agencies	3	Trusted	Secret	Interstellar
Misidentified villain	General population	2	Distrusted	Public	Regional
Survivor of annihilation	Cosmic witnesses	4	Respected/Feared	Restricted	Galactic
Protector of one world	Planetary population	4	Admired	Public	Planetary

21. Production, Audit, Testing, and Legacy Conversion | From complete rules to validated game

Sheet Architecture

The standard character record is modular rather than overcrowded. The core set contains Identity and Tier; Attributes and Skills; derived tracks; Powers; Merits and Flaws; Backgrounds and Reputation; equipment; Injuries and Conditions; and advancement. Separate records support detailed Powers, Safe Havens/Lairs, projects, Formations, organizations, and missions.

Sheet	Required Fields
Core Character	Identity, Tier, species, Attributes, derived traits, Health, WP, Reserve, Strain, defenses, Scale
Skills	All 29 Skills, ratings, automatic successes, Specializations, equipment modifiers
Powers	Scope, rating, Attribute, origin, Basic, Branches, Techniques, Energy, range, Area, duration, Scale, counters
Merits/Flaws/Backgrounds/Reputation	Ratings, frequency, triggers, jurisdiction, state, audience, Facet, visibility, RP
Equipment/Injuries	Grade, EP, damage/Protection, AP, Structure, Hardness, traits, damage, Conditions, treatment
Safe Haven/Lair	Rating, Capacity, configuration, modules, Structure, Security, Pressure, access, emergency protocol
Project	Complexity, threshold, Progress, interval, facility, Instability, BP, Workfronts, Debt, DP, ownership
Formation	Magnitude, Quality, Cohesion, Supply, attacks, defense, Morale, domains, assets, objective
Mission	Objectives, Load, Stakes, Intelligence, Advantages, support, pressure, nodes, extraction, outcome

Rules Consolidation

Precedence	Source
1	Latest explicit user-established canon
2	Consolidated core rule
3	Specific subsystem rule
4	Catalogue entry
5	Character or item exception
6	Worked example

A specific rule overrides a general rule only within its scope. Examples never override formulas. Fractions round down unless a rule explicitly says otherwise. Reserved terms must be used mechanically: Action, Reaction, Turn, Round, Interval, Tier, Grade, Rating, Magnitude, Quality, Scale, Structure, Hardness, Protection, Reserve, Strain, Cohesion, Progress, Instability, Pressure, Alarm, Alert, Exposure, and Lair Pressure.

Canonical Distinctions

- Tier is not Threat Classification.
- Magnitude is not Scale.
- Grade is not Power Rating.
- Structure is not Health.
- Cohesion is not a literal casualty count.
- Local Alarm is not Mission Alert.
- Exposure is not Lair Pressure.
- Teamwork dice are not Combined Power Points.
- Background access is not technical competence.
- Power Rating does not automatically grant Area or Scale.

Consistency Audit

Severity	Meaning
Critical	Breaks play, creates infinite resources, removes agency, makes legal characters impossible, or causes unavoidable destruction.
Major	Strong exploit, unreliable subsystem, invalidated option, or repeated dispute.

Severity	Meaning
Minor	Narrow exploit, unclear timing, or limited imbalance.
Editorial	Mechanically sound but needs terminology, example, formatting, or cross-reference.

Audit terminology, formulas, dice, automatic successes, action economy, stacking, damage and healing, Scale, Powers, species, equipment, Backgrounds, projects, encounters, Mass Combat, and subsystem interfaces.

Canonical Clarifications

- Attribute allocations are bonus dots above the universal starting rating of 1.
- Species bonuses apply after Attribute category allocations.
- Specialization picks cannot exceed Skill-unlocked slots; unused picks are banked.
- A free racial Power waives only the initial rating-1 Scope cost.
- Ordinary modifiers apply to an active defense pool before conversion to Passive Defense; automatic successes are added afterward.
- Teamwork dice and Combined Power Points are separate.
- Suppressed severity summarizes typed suppression but does not bypass the Suppression Rating/Value contest.
- Highest Protection applies fully, half second-highest rounded down; other ordinary sources do not stack.
- No unlimited extra-action loops; Solo Tempo is encounter architecture, not a player trait.
- Magnitude never increases Potency Scale.
- Encounter class is the second-highest axis except explicit hard overrides.
- Parallel project Teams use parent intervals, not additional maximum rolls.
- Breather, Short Rest, Full Rest, Recovery Day, and Recovery Week are distinct.
- Alert, Exposure, Lair Pressure, and local Alarm remain separate tracks.
- Cohesion damage is not direct casualty count.
- A Safe Haven module uses full rating as Facility Rating, but active bonus is half rating rounded up, maximum +3.

Mathematical Playtesting

Analytical estimates identify obvious issues; Monte Carlo trials verify actual probabilities. Simulations must reproduce exploding 10s, natural-1 cancellation, original-pool botches, automatic successes, defender-wins-ties, and the desperation die. Use at least 10,000 trials per probability test.

Test	Acceptance Target
Balanced equal-Tier attack vs active defense	40-65% hit rate
Offense specialist vs balanced defense	65-80%
Balanced attack vs defense specialist	25-40%
Ordinary same-Tier successful hit	10-25% typical maximum Health
Strong Technique hit	20-40%
Grand Technique hit	35-60%
Ultimate Technique hit	50-80%
Standard encounter duration	3-5 rounds
Severe duration	4-6 rounds
Boss duration	5-8 rounds
Active healing	15-30% of one typical Health pool
Passive healing	5-15% per round
Repeatable hard control	Normally no more than 50-65% application vs equal Tier
Hostile action ratio	Above 1.25 requires explicit review

Test balanced, offense, defense, controller, healer/support, movement, suppression, social, and psychic profiles at every Tier. Record mean and median successes, hit and Critical rate, botch rate, mean/median/90th-percentile damage, one-hit incapacitation, Condition uptime, Reserve use, Strain, and healing locks.

Campaign Playtesting

Wave	Sessions	Focus
Rules Alpha	4-6	Street/Standard creation, Skills, combat, Conditions, healing, equipment, Backgrounds, rests
Operational Beta	8-12	Standard/PARAGON infiltration, social, psychic, digital, chases, hazards, Lairs, encounters, missions, advancement, projects

Wave	Sessions	Focus
High-Tier Stress	4-6	JSS/Planetary/Interstellar Scale, Area, Combined Powers, regeneration, suppression, Ultimates, mass combat, mixed Tier
Legacy Validation	2-4	Converted legacy characters, concept preservation, extra actions, durability, signature capabilities, player acceptance

Every session records scene type, expected and actual encounter class, expected and actual rounds, resource loss, attacks, hit rate, Criticals, damage, Conditions, healing, incapacitations, rules lookups, disputes, GM preparation, mission pressure, Background use, and feedback. One major variable is changed at a time, then the original scenario is retested.

HONEST COMPLETION STATUS

The test procedures and acceptance gates are complete. The game cannot honestly be described as fully playtested until actual simulations and table sessions are run, recorded, evaluated, revised, and repeated.

Legacy Conversion

Legacy characters are rebuilt by concept and demonstrated feats rather than preserving raw legacy values. The conversion priority is identity, narrative Tier, signature capability, defining weakness, relationships and status, demonstrated feats, then old numbers.

62. Determine current Tier from demonstrated capability.
63. Write protected concept statements.
64. Rebuild Attributes within current allocations and caps.
65. Map old broad Skills into the current twenty-nine Skills without duplicating one rating at full value.
66. Decompose old Powers into parent Powers, Branches, Techniques, Refinements, Scale, Area, and limitations.
67. Replace unrestricted extra actions with Super Speed, repeated attacks, Reaction refresh, Movement or Minor permissions, limited Signature/Ultimate effects, or independent entities where appropriate.
68. Recalculate Health rather than converting old Health directly.
69. Convert damage, defenses, equipment, Merits, Flaws, Backgrounds, Reputation, and Threat Classification.
70. Reconstruct earned XP and resolve over-budget capabilities.
71. Complete a final conversion audit with the player.

Durability Conversion

Old Health is never translated directly. New Health uses the current formula. Preserve exceptional durability through Stamina, Super Endurance, Protection, Toughened Physique, resistance, Regeneration, Force Fields, barriers, continuity anchors, Injury resistance, and Willpower.

Legacy XP Allowance

Campaign History	Additional XP
Newly introduced	0
Established	25
Veteran	60
Iconic	120
Foundational or long-running	220

Use recorded XP when available. An allowance is used only when records do not exist and is spent through normal current costs.

Over-Budget Capabilities

- Raise Tier when the character consistently demonstrates a higher level.
- Convert the excess into a limited Signature, Ultimate, once-per-scene, once-per-Full-Rest, high-Energy, or high-Strain ability.
- Record the excess as sealed, damaged, unavailable, milestone-locked, or story-dependent.
- Do not delete a defining capability without an explanation and return path.

KURATHI RESTRICTION

Kurathi remain unavailable for normal player conversion. Mythos is the sole playable exception unless explicit future canon changes this rule.

Appendix A. Quick Reference | Core formulas and table-use reminders

Core Formulas

Rule	Formula
Ordinary roll	Attribute + Skill
Direct Power roll	Governing Attribute + Power Rating
Health	10 + Stamina x2 + Size x2
Willpower	Resolve + Composure
Reserve	Resolve + Tier Base
Strain Limit	Stamina + Resolve
Initiative	Wits + Dexterity
Speed	5 + Dexterity + Size
Passive Defense	Modified active pool / 4 rounded up + automatic successes
Passive Awareness	(Wits + Awareness) / 3 rounded up, minimum 1, + automatic successes
Formation Cohesion	10 + Magnitude x4 + Quality x2
Safe Haven Capacity	2 + Safe Haven Rating x2
Safe Haven Core Structure	15 + Safe Haven Rating x10
Expected Success Value	Rolled dice / 3 + automatic successes

Common Action Reminders

- One Standard, one Movement, one Minor, one Reaction, and Free Actions per round.
- Defender wins ties.
- Critical Success begins at 5 net successes.
- Natural 10s explode; natural 1s cancel successes; botch uses original dice only.
- Ordinary modifiers cap at +5/-5. Teamwork caps at +5 separately.
- Repeated attacks: second -3, third -6, fourth -9 exceptional.
- Protection: highest full + half second-highest, rounded down.
- One Willpower per roll; normally one on own turn and one on a Reaction before next turn.
- Short Rest after about 4 Recovery Load; Full Rest after about 8.

Damage Sequence

72. Declare and validate action.
73. Build attack and defense.
74. Roll and calculate net successes.
75. Raw Damage = Base Damage + net + Critical benefit.
76. Apply Protection and AP.
77. Apply resistance, vulnerability, immunity, and Scale.
78. Apply Health/Structure/Cohesion and Conditions/Injuries.
79. Pay resources and resolve Strain/collateral.

Condition Recovery

Use the specific Condition entry. Willpower may ignore ordinary penalties until the next turn but does not remove the Condition. Conditions requiring Medicine, repair, removal of the source, or a specific Power cannot be cleared with a generic Recover action.

Appendix B. Blank Record Templates | Compact manuscript versions

Character Summary

Field	Entry	Field	Entry
Character		Tier	
Heroic Identity		Species/Lineage	
Allegiance		Threat Class	
Concept		Size/Scale	
Motivation		Origin	

Attribute	Rating	Attribute	Rating	Attribute	Rating
Strength		Intelligence		Charisma	
Dexterity		Wits		Manipulation	
Stamina		Resolve		Composure	

Derived	Max	Current	Derived	Value
Health			Initiative	
Willpower			Speed	
Reserve			Evasion	
Strain Limit			Parry	
			Block	
			Mental Defense	
			Social Defense	

Mission Record

Field	Entry
Mission Name	
Sponsor/Authority	
Operational Level/Load	
Stakes	
Primary Objective	
Secondary Objectives	
Rules of Engagement	
Constraints	
Intelligence Level	
Prepared Advantages	
Support Assets	
Pressure Tracks	
Extraction	
Outcome/Aftermath	

Project Record

Field	Entry
Project	
Complexity/Threshold	
Difficulty/Interval	
Max Intervals	
Facility/Materials	
Progress	
Instability	
Breakthrough Points	
Workfronts	
Interface Debt	
Disruption Points	
Ownership/Class	
Completion State	

Formation Record

Field	Entry	Field	Entry
Formation		Side	
Magnitude		Quality	
Cohesion		Supply	
Attack		Defense	
Morale		Protection	
Mobility		Command Link	
Domains		Objective	
Attachments		Standing Order	

Appendix C. Glossary and Current Development Status |

Reserved terms and remaining original design work

Glossary

Term	Definition
Action	A defined expenditure within a Turn: Standard, Movement, Minor, Reaction, Full, or Free.
Alarm	Local infiltration response track.
Alert	Mission-wide awareness that an operation is occurring.
Area Scale	The extent of space or number of targets an effect can cover.
Automatic Success	A success added without rolling, usually from traits above 10.
Background	External access, relationship, position, or property.
Branch	A purchased domain within a Framework Power.
Cohesion	A Formation's ability to remain operational; not a literal casualty count.
Condition	A temporary or persistent state with explicit mechanical effects.
Energy	The cost paid from Power Reserve to activate Techniques and effects.
Exposure	Discovery track for identity, operation, project, or secret.
Grade	Equipment technology and access level, 0-6.
Hardness	Protection for objects and equipment.
Instability	Project or ritual volatility and failure risk.
Interval	One unit of Progress resolution for an extended action or project.
Lair Pressure	Hostile discovery and planning pressure against a Lair.
Magnitude	Formation number and operational footprint, M0-M8.
Potency Scale	The level at which an effect can directly contest another effect or target.
Power Rating	Strength and development of a Power, 1-15.
Progress	Accumulated successes toward an objective or project.
Protection	Damage reduction before resistance and vulnerability.
Quality	Training and coordination level of a Formation or Work Team.
Recovery Load	Encounter pacing measure for expected recovery needs.
Reserve	Energy available to fuel Powers.
Scale	Universal impact category S0-S8, separated into Potency, Area, Movement, and Structure.
Strain	Accumulated stress from Power use, Overcharge, and exceptional exertion.
Structure	Health of objects, barriers, fortifications, and equipment.
Technique	A purchased Power permission with a minimum rating and cost.
Threat Classification	Institutional classification of known danger; separate from Tier.
Tier	Character-creation and advancement band.
Workfront	A separately managed component of a multi-team project.

Current Development Status

This manuscript compiles the established core engine, catalogues, campaign procedures, production framework, and conversion rules. The following work remains external to the compiled rules or requires empirical execution rather than additional written framework:

- Organization and faction mechanics have not yet received a complete canonical subsystem.
- Vehicle construction remains intentionally outside the current core; Vehicle is a Background granting access to completed profiles.
- Mathematical simulation must be run and recorded.
- Campaign playtest waves must be conducted and evaluated.
- Legacy characters must be individually converted after the first validation pass.
- Editorial cross-references, final artwork, setting maps, and commercial layout remain production tasks rather than missing game mechanics.

Kurathi remain excluded from standard player-species and character-creation options. Mythos is the sole playable exception.